GREAT OFFERS!
Scan to Subscribe

The Pioneer

TRUSTED SINCE 1865

NEW DELHI | THURSDAY, OCTOBER 15, 2026 | PAGES 12 | ₹5.00

RNI No. 53466/91. Vol.36 Issue 286

PUBLISHED FROM: DELHI LUCKNOW BHOPAL RAIPUR BHUBANESWAR RANCHI CHANDIGARH DEHRADUN HYDERABAD VIJAYAWADA THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

www.dailypioneer.com
facebook.com/dailypioneer
instagram.com/dailypioneer
@TheDailyPioneer
linkedin.com/in/dailypioneer

PAGE 5
NATION
Didi is with you, for you always: Mamata tells CJP

PAGE 8
GLOBAL
Russia still hitting energy sites, says Zelenskyy

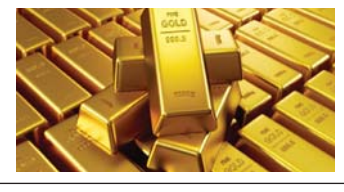
PAGE 10
BUSINESS
Gold sheds ₹1,800 as strong rupee adds to bullion woes

PAGE 11
LAW & JUSTICE
SC asks MEA to notify kin of Russia war victims

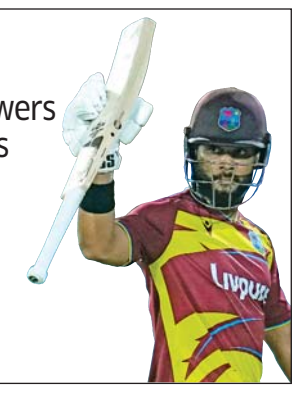
PAGE 12
SPORTS
Hope's ton powers West Indies to 247/3









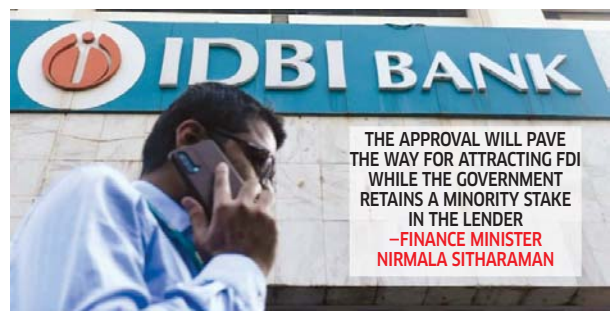


IDBI Bank goes to Fairfax in ₹52,878 crore mega deal

RAHUL DATTA ■ New Delhi

In a far-reaching decision to privatise public sector banks, the Government on Wednesday approved the sale of a 60.72 per cent stake in the Industrial Bank of India (IDBI) to Canada-based Fairfax Financial Holdings, owned by V Prem Watsa, for ₹52,878 crore. It is the country's biggest strategic disinvestment since the sale of Air India. Once completed, it will be the largest Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) in the financial sector so far.

This decision by the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA), headed by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, ends a process that has stretched over five years and marks a significant step in the Government's efforts to reduce its ownership of State-run assets and attract private capital into the financial sector. Prem Watsa-led Fairfax will pay ₹81 per share, above the benchmark fair value of ₹75.99 set by two independent valuation agencies, an official statement said.



The deal marks a major milestone in a long-delayed effort to privatise IDBI Bank and reduce State ownership of commercial enterprises. The sale process began in 2022 and faced a setback earlier this year when initial bids fell below the Government's reserve price. IDBI Bank shares rose 9.07 per cent on Wednesday to close at ₹90.44 per share on BSE after the announcement. Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said the approval will pave the way for attracting FDI, while the Government retains a minority stake in the lender.

"Propelled by Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri @narendramodi's visionary leadership, India's reform trajectory reaches another milestone today with the CCEA's approval of IDBI Bank's strategic restructuring," she said. The move will strengthen India's banking ecosystem and help banking services meet global benchmarks, she said.

Sitharaman said the decision reflects the Indian economy's resilience and the Government's continued commitment to reforms.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

Two CJP leaders in judicial custody

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) leaders Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were remanded to five days' judicial custody on Wednesday for allegedly trespassing into private property to reach Jantar Mantar, a denotified protest site, and violating bonds requiring them to maintain peace, police said. Their associate, Ajinkya Shinde, was bound down to maintain peace and good behaviour for six months and released on a personal bond with a surety of ₹5,000.

Delhi Police has registered two FIRs against 14 members of the CJP for allegedly trespassing into Jantar Mantar, which has been denotified as a designated protest site, and obstructing police personnel from discharging their official duties.

In his order, Special Executive Magistrate (SEM) Mahesh Kumar Meena said the leaders' past conduct showed they had violated lawful directions of the authorities. He noted that they had executed bonds to maintain peace and good behaviour for a year but allegedly breached them after their release by issuing protest calls on social media and attempting to mobilise people at Jantar Mantar on Saturday (October 10).

CONTINUED ON >> P4



CJP is AAP's 'B' team: CM Rekha

RAJESH KUMAR ■ New Delhi

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Wednesday launched a fierce attack on the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), calling it the "B" party of the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), and accused Rahul Gandhi, Arvind Kejriwal and leaders of the INDIA Bloc of "colluding with foreign elements" to harm India.

"The country is progressing and strengthening its position on the global stage. This is what troubles them. By joining hands with people abroad who are jealous of India, they continue to work towards harming the country," she said while addressing a press conference.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

Paneer or fake? Delhi HC seeks Centre, FSSAI stand

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Delhi High Court on Wednesday sought the stand of the FSSAI, the Centre, and the city Government in a PIL raising concerns about the sale of dairy analogue/non-dairy products as 'paneer' to unsuspecting consumers. The petitioners contended that while paneer is a standardised dairy product under the food safety regime, a non-dairy, analogue product contains non-milk ingredients and lacks the same nutritional value.



A bench of acting Chief Justice Nitin W Sambre and Justice Sanjay Singh issued notices to the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI), the Centre and the Delhi government on the petition filed by Ridhima Singh and Avlokiteshwar Padmapani Sidharth, and asked them to file their replies within six weeks.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

Rail insurance mandatory from October 27, says SC

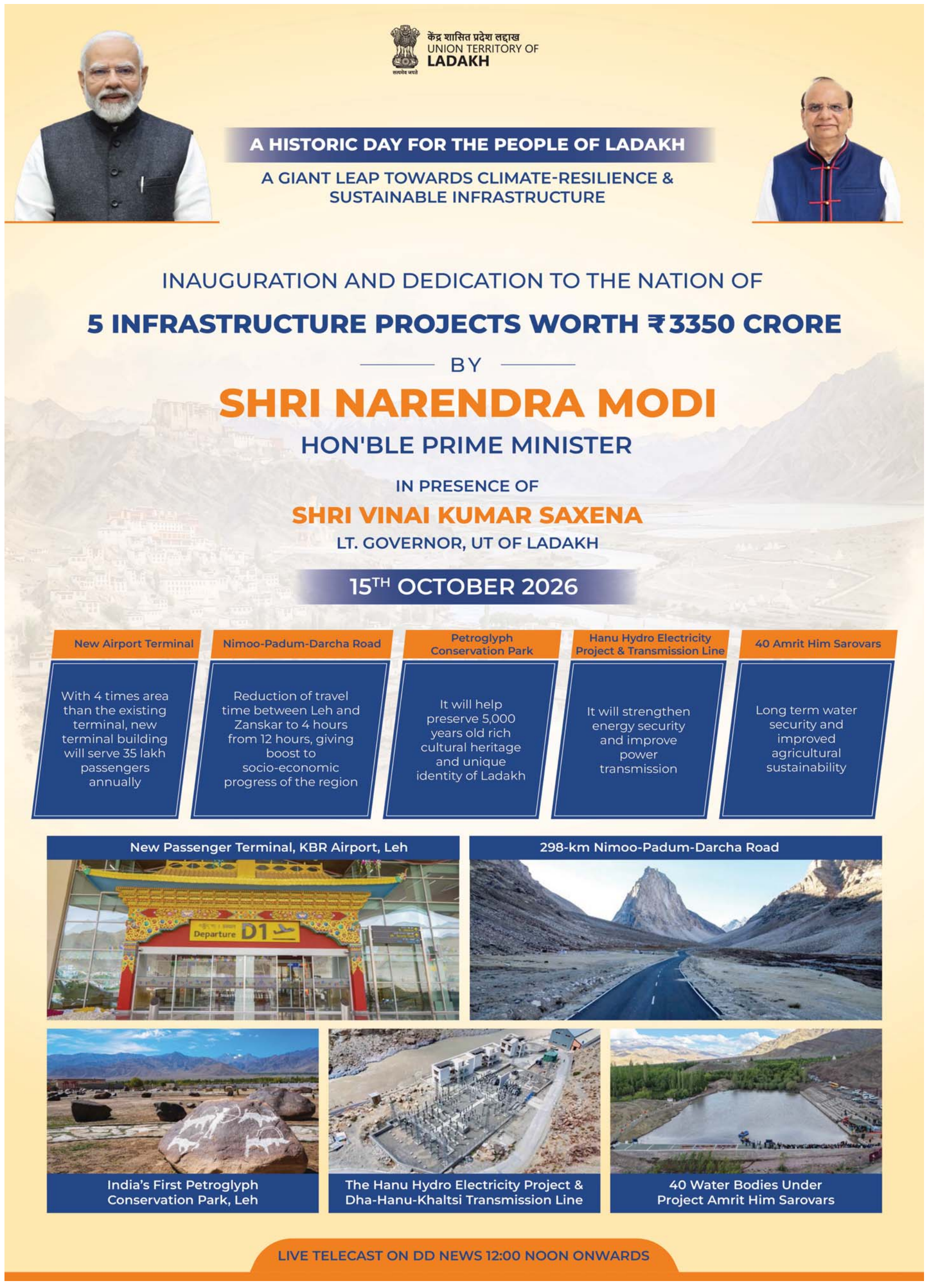
PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

In a move to extend coverage to all train travellers, the Supreme Court has directed the Railways to provide insurance for tickets purchased over the counter from October 27, warning that the Railway Board would be directly responsible for any failure to implement the order.

The October 6 direction came on a plea filed in the wake of the June 2023 Odisha train accident, seeking a commission of inquiry to probe the crash, which the petitioner attributed to the non-implementation of the Kavach safety system. The plea also sought directions to the authorities to ensure its early implementation across all trains.

Hearing the matter, the bench of Justices Ahsanuddin Amanullah and R Mahadevan expanded its scope to cover various aspects of passenger safety, including railway foot over bridges, fencing of tracks, and the lack of insurance for tickets purchased over the counter.

The court accepted the request and put its order summoning the Chairman and members of the Railway Board on hold.



The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | THURSDAY | OCTOBER 15, 2026

CM visits Mukherjee Nagar, listens to students' woes

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta made a surprise inspection of Mukherjee Nagar on Wednesday evening, sitting down with students at a tea shop in the Capital's coaching hub to hear firsthand complaints about high PG rents, poor street lighting, contaminated drinking water and the lack of affordable libraries.

During the visit, students preparing for competitive examinations and those enrolled in various universities raised a wide range of civic grievances directly with the Chief Minister, who directed officials and local representatives on the spot to act on several of the issues.

Students told the Chief Minister that affordable libraries were scarce in the area and that existing ones shut frequently, disrupting their preparation. They said high fees and operational hurdles made it difficult to find a stable place to study. The Chief Minister directed officials to examine the condition, structural safety and operating status of libraries currently functioning in the area, and asked the local MLA and officials to identify vacant plots or available community buildings where a free library could be set up for students.

On housing, students raised concerns over high Paying Guest rents, security deposits and brokerage charges, telling the Chief Minister that the shortage of hostels was forcing many to rely on private PGs and rented rooms with small spaces, poor ventilation and ongoing construction nearby. The Chief Minister said the Delhi Government was working on a PG policy and on increasing hostel availability to provide organised housing options for students. Students also raised concerns about food quality and living conditions inside PGs.

Female students raised safety concerns, particularly around commuting during late evening hours and poorly lit stretches in the area. The Chief Minister directed officials and police representatives to review the status of street lights and CCTV cameras and take corrective action where required. She also instructed police to act against vehicles found with illegally dark tinted windows operating in the area.

Woman journalist, two others booked under SC/ST Act on ACP bhagat's plea

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



ACP Vivek Bhagat

Delhi Police have registered a case under the SC/ST Act against a woman journalist and two others on a complaint by an Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP). The officer alleges they made casteist remarks against him, publicly humiliated him, and obstructed his duty during a protest in Delhi on October 3.

The FIR was registered on October 13 at Parliament Street Police Station on the complaint of ACP Vivek Bhagat, who is posted in the Connaught Place subdivision. Journalist Rosy, Gajendra Singh, who is associated with a news portal, and an unidentified person are named as accused. The case has been registered under Sections 221, 356(2) and 3(5) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), along with provisions of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act.

Bhagat has himself been at the centre of allegations of harassment of women protesters during the recent agitation against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. Those allegations are being investigated by the Crime Branch.

According to the complaint, the incident took place at Buta Singh Roundabout on October 3. Police personnel had been deployed there to manage a protest called by Neha Bora and others against the Election Commission of India (ECI). The ACP said the protesters gathered around 2:30 pm and tried to march towards Jantar Mantar. Police personnel announced that restrictions under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) were in force and asked the protesters to disperse. When they allegedly refused to leave, the police began detaining them.

Bhagat belongs to the Megh/Meghwal Scheduled Caste community. He alleged that Rosy made derogatory remarks about his caste after referring to his nameplate. He claimed the remarks were made in the presence of her colleague Gajendra Singh and others. The ACP further alleged that around 3 pm, while he was helping a bus carrying detainees move, Rosy accused him of sexually assaulting her. He claimed that she and her colleagues repeatedly confronted him, questioned his conduct and obstructed him from carrying out his official responsibilities. According to the complaint, Rosy, Singh and others later gathered outside Parliament Street Police Station at around 6:15 pm and staged a protest against him. Bhagat alleged that they raised slogans and portrayed him as a sexual predator and a potential rapist. He also claimed that posts and reels targeting him were later circulated on X and Instagram by the accused and others, including members of the Cockroach Janata Party.

Parvesh Verma launches DJB's control centre

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Delhi Water Minister Parvesh Verma on Wednesday launched the Intelligent Command and Control Centre (ICCC) of Delhi Jal Board (DJB). Under the digital platform, the entire water network will be on one screen, including consumer complaints, maintenance, hydraulic model, digital twin and water tanker fleet GPS tracking.

"For us, water management is not just about supplying water. It is equally important to prevent wastage, identify problems quickly and ensure that people do not have to suffer because of a pipeline leak or an avoidable disruption," Verma said.

The ICCC platform brings together data from SCADA systems, Geographic Information Systems (GIS), smart meters, consumer complaints, maintenance systems and GPS-enabled field vehicles. Technology must translate into a visible improvement in the everyday lives of Delhi's residents, he added.

"It will allow officials to monitor the network, identify vulnerable locations, track repair teams and review the status of complaints through an integrated dashboard," an official said.

According to officials, through this system, real-time tracking of field crews, tankers and the Emergency Response Vehicle, along with location-based, faster resolution of consumer complaints will be available.

JWIL is currently executing the DJB's Chandrawal Water Supply Project under Packages 2, 3 and 4, covering areas that together account for approximately 10 per cent of Delhi's population and geographical area, including important VIP areas; the same company will manage the Centre also.

Two-day musical Kumauni Ramlila at Pyarelal auditorium from October 17

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



For two evenings this week, a slice of the Kumaon hills will sit inside a Delhi auditorium. The Kumauni Ramlila, where the story of Lord Ram is sung rather than spoken, will be staged on October 17 and 18 at the Pyarelal Auditorium at ITO.

The two-day event is organised by Shri Ram Sevak Parvatiya Kala Manch. The group describes it as a modest effort to reconnect people from Uttarakhand living in the Delhi-NCR region with their roots and to revive cherished memories of the mountains. The initiative has been running continuously for the past three years. The organising committee said the aim is to offer the Kumauni community in Delhi-NCR a brief yet special glimpse of this experience.

What sets the performance apart is its music. Dialogues are rendered as Chaupais, Dohas and sorathas set to classical and semi-classical ragas. These include Bhairavi, Malkauns, Jaijaivanti, Bihag, Pilu and Maan. The organisers say this blend of devotional storytelling, music and theatre gives the performance a unique identity.

New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Main Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida, G.B. Nagar, (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on NOIDA Authority's official website: **www.noidaauthorityonline.in** & **http://etender.up.nic.in.** Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

(A)

1. **44/S.M.-Jal-III/E.T./2026-27,** Strengthening of Sewerage (Raising of Boundary Wall & Repair of Internal Road & Other Miscellaneous work at SPS Sector-43), Noida. Cost Rs. 92.69 Lacs
2. **19/S.M.(Jal-O.A.)/2026-27,** O/M of STP (Two year annual Repairing & Rewinding of Booster Motor & Other Allied Electrical work at UGR STP, Sector-123), Noida. Cost Rs. 66.08 Lacs
3. **20/S.M.(Jal-O.A.)/2026-27,** O/M of MSPS/IPS & Sewer Line at Expressway (Two Year Annual Repairing of Non-Clog Pump, Automatic Starter at IPS-5, Sector-154 & IPS-6, Sector-166), Noida. Cost Rs. 72.00 Lacs

Which can be uploaded by date: 28.10.2026 upto 5:00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date:- 29.10.2026 at 11:00 AM.

(B)

1. **38/S.M.-Jal-III/E.T./2026-27,** M/o W/s (S/F of Line Shaft for UGR & Tubewell in Sector-92, 93, 93A & B, Village-Gejha), Noida. (AMC For Two Years). Cost Rs. 97.32 Lacs
2. **39/S.M.-Jal-III/E.T./2026-27,** M/o Sewerage (Annual P/F Cover Frames & Cleaning of Sewer Manholes in Sector-142, 143, 144 & 5% Abadi Sector-141, 144), Noida. (For Two Years). Cost Rs. 46.13 Lacs
3. **04/S.M.(Jal-O.A.)/2026-27,** O/M of Sewer Line and MSPS/SPS at Expressway (Two year Repairing and Rewinding of 75/90 HP Submersible Pump at IPS-7, Sector-129), Noida. Cost Rs. 58.71 Lacs

Which can be uploaded by date:- 21.10.2026 upto 5:00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date:- 22.10.2026 at 11:00 AM.

Office
Sector-5, Noida

General Manager (Jal)
Noida

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform general public that Mrs. Raj Kumari has acquired Back Side Portion on Lower Ground Floor "The said floor", area measuring 720 Sq. Feet., part of Property No. 154 (New No.) and 127 (Old No.), part of Khasra No. 189/150, situated in the area of village Garhi Jharia Maria, presently known as Sant Nagar, East of Kailash, New-Delhi, by way of Sale Deed dated 20.08.2008 (Doc No. 13013). Now, Mrs. Raj Kumari intending to sell said property to Mr. Anuj Kumar Tiwari and further availing a loan on above said property from Truhome Finance Limited (earlier known as Shriram Housing Finance Ltd.) In case anyone has any objection, the same may be raised within 7 days of this publication to Mr. Ajit Sharma (Advocate), Partner of AccuLaw Source LLP, Office no. 361, 2nd Floor, Sec-1, Vaishali, Ghaziabad, U.P. Pincode 201010 or contact : +91 9560309909 (M).

PUBLIC NOTICE

Reg: Plot Bearing No. 199, land area measuring 31.69 sq. mts., situated in Block-E, Pocket-20, Sector-03, situated in the layout plan of Rohini Residential Scheme, Delhi; hereinafter referred to as "said property";

Be it known to all that our client, Mr. Raj Mani and Mrs. Indu Saroj (hereinafter called the "Purchaser") intend to purchase the said property from Mr. Anil Kumar and Mrs. Rachna (hereinafter called the "Sellers") who owned the said property vide Sale Deed dated 02.04.2026 executed by Mr. Pushkar Dutt Bansal, registered as document no. 2026/13/I/3777. It has been further informed that initially, Mr. P.R. Rattu and Mrs. Harbajan Kaur were the owner of the said property vide Perpetual Lease Deed dated 18.03.1992. Thereafter, the said property has been sold to to Mr. Kaku Ram vide GPA, ATS & Will dated 27.03.1992. Further, transferred to Mr. K.S. Negi vide GPA, ATS & Will dated 10.12.1992. And then, transferred to Mrs. Swaran Lata Bansal vide ATS and Registered Will dated 26.04.1993 and a Conveyance Deed dated 02.03.2012 executed in her favour. Thereafter, Mrs. Swaran Lata Bansal expired leaving behind legal heirs namely Mr. Jatin Bansal, Mrs. Neha Aggarwal and Mr. Pushkar Dutt Bansal. Out of three legal heirs, two of them have relinquished their respective shares in favour of Mr. Pushkar Dutt Bansal vide Relinquishment Deed dated 02.04.2025. Finally, Mr. Pushkar Dutt Bansal sold the said property to sellers as mentioned above. The sellers have also informed the purchaser that the said property is not mortgaged anywhere and there is no charge or dispute or any litigation pending regarding the said property.

Any person including Bank/s, Financial Institution/s. relative/s having any claim, right, title or any interest of any nature whatsoever into or upon the aforesaid property is hereby called upon to make the same known, in writing, with documentary evidence, by Registered AD Post, to the undersigned at the address mentioned herein below within 07 days of publication of this notice and in the event of no response having been received to the notice, the title of the sellers to the said property shall be deemed to be clear of any charge or encumbrance of any nature whatsoever and any subsequent claim shall not bind our client/Purchaser, in any manner whatsoever.

Shivkant Arora, Advocate
M/s Intellective Law Offices
A-74, LGF, Defence Colony,
New Delhi -110024

Office of the Superintending Engineer, Construction Circle,
Uttarakhand Peyjal Nigam, Haldwani, District- Nainital (Uttarakhand)
(E-mail: se.circlentl@gmail.com, Phone: 05946-298296)

Letter No./Bid No.: 2893/614/03 Dated 14.10.2026

E-Tendering/Tender Notice

1	**Name of work:-**	Rising Mains, Distribution Network, Overhead Tank, Pump House, & Pumping Plants and its appurtenant works under **Umedhpur Awasiye Pariyojana Water Supply Scheme.** Period of Completion: 12 Months
2	**Date of Online Publication:-**	**17.10.2026 at 18:00 hrs.**
3	Details of other key dates, tender information etc. may be obtained at web site: **www.uktenders.gov.in**	

Superintending Engineer

kotak Kotak Mahindra Bank

NOTICE

Locker Hired by **MRS. VANYA SHARMA** having address at **11 N W A PUNJABI BAGH, NEW DELHI DELHI-110026** with **KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK** Situated at **55 WEST AVENUE , PUNJABI BAGH, NEW DELHI 110026** remains un-operated from last 9 years & 8 months and the rent due for the last 8 years.

All the 3 letters earlier sent to **MRS. VANYA SHARMA** calling her to clear dues and to operate the locker has returned unserved and she is not contactable.

It is hereby informed that despite this notice, if dues not cleared and locker is not operated by **MRS. VANYA SHARMA** within 90 days from the date of this notice, break open of the said locker will be done on **13 January 2027** at around **12p.m.**

kotak Kotak Mahindra Bank

NOTICE

Locker Hired by **MRS. SANGEETA SHARMA** having address at **J-39, B K DUTT COLONY, JOR BAGH LANE, NEW DELHI 110003** with **KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK** Situated at **55 WEST AVENUE , PUNJABI BAGH, NEW DELHI 110026** remained un-operated since last 9 years & 10 months and the rent due for the last 7 years.

All the 3 letters earlier sent to **MRS. SANGEETA SHARMA** calling her to clear dues and to operate the locker has returned unserved and she is not contactable.

It is hereby informed that despite this notice, if dues not cleared and locker is not operated by **MRS. SANGEETA SHARMA** within 90 days from the date of this notice, break open of the said locker will be done on **13 January 2027** at around **12p.m.**

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, Malti Rawat W/o late Dhyan Singh Rawat R/o UNI Apartment, MIG, Flat No. 3, GH-2, Sector-11, Vasundhara, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh—hereby disinherit my son, Sunil Singh Rawat, and his wife, Swati Rawat, from my movable and immovable property. Anyone engaging in any dealings or transactions with them shall be solely responsible for the consequences.

Public Notice

This is to inform general public that Mrs. Sarita W/o Mr. Ghan Shyam Das has acquired Property Bearing Plot No. 2/2, land area measuring 82 SQ. YDS., out of khasra no. 13/7, situated in the area of village Razapur Khurd Delhi State Delhi colony known as Raksha Enclave, Mohan Garden, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059, by way of Notarised GPA, Notarised ATS & Will dated 12.08.2024. Now, Mrs. Sarita W/o Mr. Ghan Shyam Das intending to sell said property to Mrs. Suman Dutta W/o Amrender Kumar Dutta and further availing a loan on above said property from Truhome Finance Limited (earlier known as Shriram Housing Finance Ltd.) In case anyone has any objection, the same may be raised within 7 days of this publication to Mr. Ajit Sharma (Advocate), Partner of AccuLaw Source LLP, Office no. 361, 2nd Floor, Sec-1, Vaishali, Ghaziabad, U.P. Pincode 201010 or contact : +91 9560309909 (M).

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is to inform to the public at large that **Mr. Amit Verma** became owner of vide Sale deed dated 27.12.2024 Vide doc No. 2024/25/I/34904 and of Sale deed dated 24.12.2024 Vide doc No. 2024/25/I/34549 SR-West Janakpuri., who is mortgaging Free Hold Built-Up LIG Flat no. B-2-B/293, On First Floor, & Freehold Built-up Property Bearing Flat no. B-2B/292, First Floor, Situated at Janak Puri, New Delhi-110058, same to be financed by AAVAS FINANCIERS LIMITED That, (I) Sale deed dated 18.08.2005 executed by (1) S. Gurpreet Singh (2) Mr. Mukesh Dua in favour of Mrs. Ashima Chawla in respect of First floor of Property bearing No.- B-28/293, Vide doc No. 22998, book no. 1, vol no. 13100, pages 173-179, dated 18.08.2005, SR-New Delhi & Sale deed dated 05.06.2008 executed by Mrs. Ashima Chawla in favour of Mrs. Urmil Bakshi in respect of First floor of Property bearing No.- B-28/293. Vide doc No. 13,323, book no. 1, vol No. 16,094, pages 28-33, dated 05.06.2008, SR-II, Janakpuri. & (II) Sale deed dated 18.08.2005 executed by (1) S. Gurpreet Singh & (2) Mr. Mukesh Dua in favour of Mrs. Ashima Chawla in respect of first floor out of Freehold Built-up Property bearing Flat No. B-2B/292, Vide doc No. 23007, book no. 1, vol no. 13101, pages 49-55, dated 18.08.2005, SR-II, JANAKPURI & Sale deed dated 05.06.2008 executed by Mrs. Ashima Chawla in favour of Mrs. Urmil Bakshi in respect of Entire First floor Without roof rights, freehold bearing No. B-2B/292, vide doc No. 13,270, book no. 1, vol No. 16,091, pages 193-198, dated 05.06.2008, SR-II, Janakpuri, have been lost/or not available, If any Person having any type of claim/right/title/interest over the said property, may inform in writing, at the address mentioned below, about his objections, within **7 days** from today, failing which it shall be presumed that the said property is free from all type of Encumbrances, lien etc.

Lucem Legal LLP
N-161, Ground Floor, Saira Tower, Gautam Nagar
Near Yusuf Sarai Community Centre,New Delhi-110049
Contact # 011-40046316 & 41667327

Public Notice

This is to inform the general public that **Mr. Ram Kishan** was the owner of Residential house admeasuring 325 sq. yards, bearing House No. 261, Plot No. 25, Old Municipal Corporation No. 747, situated at Uttar Soti Ganj, Tehsil and District Meerut, Uttar Pradesh through Sale Deed dated 28.11.1956 doc. no. 4512 executed by Mr. Babu Basant Singh Sarin in favour of Mr. Ram Kishan in respect of Plot No. 25, area measuring 551 sq. yards, out of Khewat No. 5. Thereafter, Notarized Will dated 25.03.1983 executed by Mr. Ram Kishan Bhargava in respect of House no. 747, half share in house in Rewari Haryana and others properties whereby it is Mentioned that House No. 747 will be given to (1) Mr. Anil Bhargava (son) (1/4th share), (2) Mrs. Shashi Bhargava (daughter) (1/4th share), (3) Mr. Anshul Bhargava S/o Mr. Sachidanand Bhargava (grandson) (1/4th share) & (4) Mrs. Shail Bhargava W/o Late Mr. S.N Bhargava. Property in Rewari it given to his sons Mr. Sachidanand Bhargava and Mr. Anil Bhargava. Unfortunately, Mr. Ram Kishan Bhargava, Mrs. Shiv Kumari Bhargav, and Mr. S.N. Bhargava expired. As per SMC, Mrs. Shiv Kumari Bhargav left behind her legal heirs are (1) Mr. Anil Bhargava (son), (2) Mrs. Shashi Bhargava (daughter), (3) Mr. Anshul Bhargava S/o Mr. Sachidanand Bhargava (grandson), (4) Mrs. Sudha Bhargava (Daughter), (5) Reetu Bhargava (Granddaughter) & (6) Mrs. Shail Bhargava (Daughter-in-law).

(1) Mr. Anil Bhargava (son), (2) Mrs. Shashi Bhargava W/o Mr. Anil Bhargava (daughter in law), (3) Mr. Anshul Bhargava S/o Mr. Sachidanand Bhargava (grandson), (4) Mrs. Shail Bhargava (Daughter-in-law) intends to transfer the ownership of above said Property by way of sale Deed to Mr. Ambuj Rastogi and the sale proceed of the same to be made in the account Mr. Anil Bhargav & Mrs. Shashi Bhargav as per there mutual understanding.

(1) Mrs. Sudha Bhargava (Daughter), (2) Reetu Bhargava (Granddaughter) and (3) Mrs. Shashi Bhargava (daughter) as per there consent they have no objection towards sale of the said property. Subsequently, Mr. Ambuj Rastogi is in the process of mortgaging the said Property with ICICI Home Finance Co. Ltd. Any objections or concerns regarding this transaction should be raised within a period of 7 days from the date of this public notice. Any objections submitted after the completion of this 7 days period will not be considered binding with respect to the said property or the interests of our client.

If anyone wishes to raise an objection, please do so within the stipulated 15-days period by contacting Law Veritas: North (Advocates & Legal Consultants) at Office No. 11, 1st Floor, Building No. A-44/A, Sector-16, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301; Landline(s): +91012-04499711, e-mail: accounts@lvnorth.in.

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is hereby notified to the general public that the below mentioned original property documents pertaining to the property being **Flat No. A- 401, The Peoples Conservative CGHS Ltd, Plot No. 10, Sector 18, Dwarka, New Delhi 110075, owned by Mr. Ravindra Bahadur Singh S/o Mr. Ram Badan Singh and Mrs. Yojana Singh W/o Mr. Ravindra Bahadur Singh** were lost/misplaced. The details of the lost property documents which is issued by The Peoples Conservative CGHS Ltd in favour of Mr. Ravindra Bahadur Singh and Mrs. Yojana Singh are as follows:

1. Certificate of Allotment bearing reference no.TPCCGH254/2012 dated 30.06.2012
2. Certificate of Occupancy
3. Share Certificate bearing no. 8843 dated 07.01.2004
4. Possession letter

Any person(s) or entity having any objection, claim of any nature whatsoever in respect of the aforesaid property is hereby called upon to intimate the same, along with supporting documents, in writing to the undersigned within **15 days from the date of publication of this notice.**

In case no objection or claim is received within the aforesaid period, it shall be presumed that no claim or objection and the owner shall be at liberty to deal with the property in accordance with law. Any person finding or having possession of the aforesaid original documents is also requested to return the same to the undersigned at the address mentioned below.

Issued by: Uzair Elahi
Address: 101-A, GF, Shiv Kutir, Behind Nafed Building,
Ashram Chowk ,New Delhi-110014
Mobile No.: +91-9953045052
Email Address: uzairelahi@hotmail.com

Date:15.10.2026
Place: New Delhi

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Tender Notice

Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement System

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001 for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	15265127	Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning DG Set	16 Set	03.11.2026
02	19260628	Set of Labyrinth Ring for Nose Suspend Drive	150 Set	09.11.2026
03	19261697A	Panto Foot Insulator	375 Nos	09.11.2026
04	77269008A RGC	Running Contract for IM Long Fish Plate	31676 Nos	16.11.2026

Note: 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. **www. ireps.gov.in** for details. 2. No manual offer will be entertained. **3573/2026**

Tender Notice No. 49/2026-2027 Dated: 13.10.2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

kotak Kotak Mahindra Bank

NOTICE

Locker Hired by **LATE MR. AJEET PAL SINGH** having address at **HOUSE NO-1344 3RD FLOOR DR.,MUKHERJEE NAGAR NEAR BATRA CINEMA, DELHI 110009** with **KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK** Situated at **55 WEST AVENUE , PUNJABI BAGH, NEW DELHI 110026** remained un-operated since it was hired and the rent due for the last 2 years.

All the 3 letters earlier sent to **LATE MR. AJEET PAL SINGH** calling him to clear dues and to operate the locker has returned unserved and he is not contactable.

It is hereby informed that despite this notice, if dues not cleared and locker is not operated by **LATE MR. AJEET PAL SINGH** within 90 days from the date of this notice, break open of the said locker will be done on **13 January 2027** at around **12p.m.**

kotak Kotak Mahindra Bank

NOTICE

Locker Hired by **MR. AMIT AGRAWAL** having address at **P4-7 BASEMENT P4 LANE, JACARANDA MARG, DLF PHASE 2, GURGAON-122002** with **KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK** Situated at **55 WEST AVENUE , PUNJABI BAGH, NEW DELHI 110026** remains un-operated from last 10 years and the rent due for the last 8 years.

All the 3 letters earlier sent to **MR. AMIT AGRAWAL** calling him to clear dues and to operate the locker has returned unserved and he is not contactable.

It is hereby informed that despite this notice, if dues not cleared and locker is not operated by **MR. AMIT AGRAWAL** within 90 days from the date of this notice, break open of the said locker will be done on **13 January 2027** at around **12p.m.**

kotak Kotak Mahindra Bank

NOTICE

Locker Hired by **MR. GOPAL AGGARWAL & KIRAN AGARWAL** having address at **19 ROAD NO 54, PUNJABI BAGH WEST, DELHI 110026** with **KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK** Situated at **55 WEST AVENUE, PUNJABI BAGH, NEW DELHI 110026** remained un-operated since it was hired and the rent due for the last 9 years.

All the 3 letters earlier sent to **MR. MR. GOPAL AGGARWAL & KIRAN AGARWAL** calling them to clear dues and to operate the locker has returned unserved and they are not contactable.

It is hereby informed that despite this notice, if dues not cleared and locker is not operated by **MR. MR. GOPAL AGGARWAL & KIRAN AGARWAL** within 90 days from the date of this notice, break open of the said locker will be done on **13 January 2027** at around **12p.m.**

kotak Kotak Mahindra Bank

NOTICE

Locker Hired by **MRS. PARAMJEET KAUR LAMBA** having address at **H NO-79 WEST AVENUE ROAD, PUNJABI BAGH,DELHI-110026** with **KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK** Situated at **55 WEST AVENUE , PUNJABI BAGH, NEW DELHI 110026** remained un-operated since it was hired and the rent due for the last 8 years.

All the 3 letters earlier sent to **MRS. PARAMJEET KAUR LAMBA** calling her to clear dues and to operate the locker has returned unserved and she is not contactable.

It is hereby informed that despite this notice, if dues not cleared and locker is not operated by **MRS. PARAMJEET KAUR LAMBA** within 90 days from the date of this notice, break open of the said locker will be done on **13 January 2027** at around **12p.m.**

kotak Kotak Mahindra Bank

NOTICE

Locker Hired by **MR. SANUJ BATHLA** having address at **1 FLAG STAFF ROAD CIVIL LINES, DELHI -110054** with **KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK** Situated at **55 WEST AVENUE , PUNJABI BAGH, NEW DELHI 110026** remains un-operated from last 8 years & 6 Months and the rent due for the last 7 years.

All the 3 letters earlier sent to **MR. SANUJ BATHLA** calling him to clear dues and to operate the locker has returned unserved and he is not contactable.

It is hereby informed that despite this notice, if dues not cleared and locker is not operated by **MR. SANUJ BATHLA** within 90 days from the date of this notice, break open of the said locker will be done on **13 January 2027** at around **12p.m.**

kotak Kotak Mahindra Bank

NOTICE

Locker Hired by **MR. SATISH BATRA** having address at **HOUSE NO 25 ROAD NO 68 WEST PUNJABI BAGH NEW DELHI 110026** with **KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK** Situated at **55 WEST AVENUE , PUNJABI BAGH, NEW DELHI 110026** remained un-operated since it was hired and the rent due for the last 8 years.

All the 3 letters earlier sent to **MR. SATISH BATRA** calling him to clear dues and to operate the locker has returned unserved and he is not contactable.

It is hereby informed that despite this notice, if dues not cleared and locker is not operated by **MR. SATISH BATRA** within 90 days from the date of this notice, break open of the said locker will be done on **13 January 2027** at around **12p.m.**

kotak Kotak Mahindra Bank

NOTICE

Locker Hired by **MRS. SUMAN AGARWAL** having address at **H NO C-49 G-F SHIVAJI PARK, PUNJABI BAGH, PUNJABI BAGH THANA, NEW DELHI 110026** with **KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK** Situated at **55 WEST AVENUE, PUNJABI BAGH, NEW DELHI 110026** remains un-operated from last 10 years & 7 Months and the rent due for the last 8 years.

All the 3 letters earlier sent to **MRS. SUMAN AGARWAL** calling her to clear dues and to operate the locker has returned unserved and she is not contactable.

It is hereby informed that despite this notice, if dues not cleared and locker is not operated by **MRS. SUMAN AGARWAL** within 90 days from the date of this notice, break open of the said locker will be done on **13 January 2027** at around **12p.m.**

kotak Kotak Mahindra Bank

NOTICE

Locker Hired by **MR. SURINDER KUMAR AHUJA** having address at **31-2-20 FOUR MARLA MODEL TOWN, GURGAON, HARYANA 122001** with **KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK** Situated at **55 WEST AVENUE, PUNJABI BAGH, NEW DELHI 110026** remained un-operated since it was hired and the rent due for the last 5 years.

All the 3 letters earlier sent to **MR. SURINDER KUMAR AHUJA** calling him to clear dues and to operate the locker has returned unserved and he is not contactable.

It is hereby informed that despite this notice, if dues not cleared and locker is not operated by **MR. SURINDER KUMAR AHUJA** within 90 days from the date of this notice, break open of the said locker will be done on **13 January 2027** at around **12p.m.**

Although every possible care and caution has been taken to avoid errors or omissions, this publication is being sold on the condition and understanding that information given in this publication is merely for reference and must not be taken as having authority of or binding in any way on the writers, editors, publishers, and printers and sellers who do not owe any responsibility for any damage or loss to any person, a purchaser of this publication or not for the result of any action taken on the basis of this work. All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent court and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only. Readers are advised and requested to verify and seek appropriate advice to satisfy themselves about the veracity of any kind of advertisement before responding to any contents published in this newspaper. The printer, publisher, editor and any employee of the Pioneer Group's will not be held responsible for any kind of claim made by the advertisers of the products & services and shall not be made responsible for any kind of loss, consequences and further product-related damages on such advertisements.

Printed and published by Kushan Mitra for and on behalf of CMYK Printech Ltd., Regd Office:- 201-205, 208-210, 2nd Floor, Pratap Bhawan 5, B.S.Z. Marg, New Delhi-110002 Phone: 011-46035729, and printed at The Indian Express Ltd., A-8, Sector 7, Dist. Gautam Budh Nagar (U.P.) Noida-201 301, Ph: 01202470700. Managing Editor Vijay Prakash Singh, Executive Editor Deepak Kumar Jha. AIR SURCHARGE of ₹ 2.00 East: Calcutta, North: Leh West: Mumbai & Ahmedabad South: Bangalore & Chennai. Central : Khajuraho. Lucknow Office: 4th Floor, Sahara Shopping Centre, Faizabad Road, Lucknow-226 016. Phone:- 9415089265

Delhi Cabinet passes 10-year industrial policy

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The Delhi Government has approved a new industrial policy for the next 10 years, focusing on tailored incentives for 10 priority sectors, including IT and IETS, global capability centres, data centres, and healthcare, to make the national Capital a technologically driven, clean industrial hub.

The Industrial Policy, 2026, approved in a Cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday, also allocated ₹1,000 crore under Mukhyamantri Udyamshree Yojana for five years to promote new industries and create jobs, said a statement from the Delhi Chief Minister's Office.

A dedicated Government agency, 'Invest Delhi', will promote investment over the 10-year policy period, serving as a single point of contact and guiding investors from initial information and site selection to securing approvals, disbursing incentives, and resolving grievances.

Invest Delhi will operate through the Delhi Udyog Mitra portal designed to make approval processes faster, simpler and more transparent, the statement said.

A salient feature of the policy is higher incentives offered to women entrepreneurs and employees, with a focus on the MSME sector.

Among the top-ten priority sectors, entrepreneurs under the Information Technology (IT), IT Enabled Services (ITES) and digital services will receive a 25 per cent incentive on digital infrastructure investment, up to ₹10 crore for three years. The incentive will be up to ₹12 crore for women entrepreneurs.

Besides, office rental assistance of 40 per cent, up to ₹2 crore, will also be provided for three years. Bandwidth



and cloud services will qualify for 25 per cent assistance for two years, capped at ₹10 lakh annually, according to the statement. Incentives of ₹40,000 to ₹50,000 will be provided for each new hire.

Incentives up to ₹50 crore (up to ₹60 crore for women) will be given on digital infrastructure investment for global capacity centres in the first five years. Office rental assistance of 40 per cent, capped at ₹2 crore, will be provided for two years, while each new hire will qualify for an incentive of ₹1 lakh to ₹1.2 lakh.

The policy also provides 50 per cent assistance for certification, up to ₹25 lakh; a 30 per cent incentive for research and development, up to ₹5 crore; and 25 per cent assistance for units developing workspaces, up to ₹10 crore.

Investment incentives for data centres, research and development and testing facility, healthcare and wellness services and urban logistics will be up to ₹10 crore (₹12 crore for women). Other sector-specific incentives such as assistance for low water consuming cooling systems, certification and data security related expenses, patent related assistance will also be available.

Research and development and testing facilities will receive ₹5 lakh per patent, for a maximum of four patents, besides getting up to ₹25 lakh for laboratory accreditation-related expenses. Healthcare investments will get ₹50,000 to ₹60,000 for hiring each new specialist doctor. New warehousing units will receive up to ₹10 crore (₹12 crore for women), while existing units will be eligible for assistance capped at ₹1 crore. Cold-chain facilities will qualify for incentives up to ₹2 crore.

Technology adoption in logistics will receive incentives capped at ₹50 lakh, while the use of green energy will qualify for incentives up to ₹2 crore. Circular economy and waste management, precision manufacturing, industry-linked skill development and technology modernisation of MSMEs will also be covered by various kinds of incentives.

The new policy seeks to position Delhi as a leading hub for advanced technology, Global Capability Centres (GCCs), data centres, research and development, healthcare services, urban logistics, and precision manufacturing by attracting fresh investments, the chief minister said.

Keeping the needs of different sectors in mind, tailored incentives would be provided for capital investment, office or workspace rentals, new hiring, research, certification, technological modernisation, energy conservation and skill development. The policy will also encourage resource reuse and waste reduction, she added.

Rahul sits on *dharna* with Ankita Bhandari's parents



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi on Wednesday evening briefly sat on a *dharna* at the India Gate lawns with the parents of Uttarakhand murder victim Ankita Bhandari. The protest was against the appointment of Dushyant Kumar Gautam as Sikkim governor.

Bhandari's parents allege that Gautam is the "VIP" mentioned in the case. His name has cropped up in the September 2022 case, but he is not named in any chargesheet yet. The protest was another surprise demonstration against the BJP Government.

Bhandari was 19 and worked as a receptionist. The case involves allegations that she was murdered for refusing sexual favours to guests at a resort in Rishikesh run by Pulkit Arya, the son of a former BJP leader.

A local court has sentenced three men to life imprisonment in the case. It gained renewed attention after an FIR was registered in January 2026 against an unidentified "VIP".

MPD-2047 proposes 138-hectare education hub in Narela

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Delhi's Master Plan 2047 (MPD-2047) proposes a 138-hectare education hub in Narela to promote research, innovation, vocational training and skilled employment. The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) shared the provision with stakeholders on Wednesday at its ninth and tenth consultations on the plan, which focused on education and healthcare.

The consultations were held under the guidance of Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu. The DDA said he has consistently pitched for adequate, affordable and accessible healthcare and education infrastructure in the Capital.



The ninth meeting dealt with the Education Hub. It was attended by representatives of the Delhi Government's Department of Education, schools, private universities, other universities and educational institutions. The DDA said the Narela hub would support universities, research institutions, vocational training and start-ups, and build a knowledge-based economy with skilled jobs.

For schools, the plan provides a higher Floor Area Ratio (FAR) to support extra-curricular infrastructure in line with the National Education Policy. It permits standalone schools and training facilities for children with disabilities and special needs, in keeping with the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act. It also allows residential schools.

The tenth meeting focused on the Medical Hub. It was attended by representatives of healthcare institutions and the health departments of the Government of India and the Delhi Government. The DDA said the plan envisages an integrated network of hospitals, medical colleges, speciality healthcare facilities and wellness centres across the city. It also aims to strengthen Delhi's role as a national healthcare hub and a destination for medical tourism through world-class tertiary and super-speciality facilities.

The plan further provides for specialised and long-term care. This includes de-addiction centres, drug-rehabilitation centres, after-care centres, early intervention centres, transitional care homes for recovery and respite care centres, along with other medical facilities.

Stakeholders gave suggestions on disaster preparedness and resilience, clarity on basement use, and rationalisation of planning norms for educational and healthcare facilities. On education, they sought clarity on FAR calculations and higher ground coverage for schools. They asked for possible relaxation of Right of Way requirements for existing nursery schools and nursing homes, and a review of parking norms for private schools.

vedanta power

LIFTING OF FLYASH, BOTTOM ASH AND POND ASH TO ALL USERS OF ASH

INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST



Vedanta Power Limited (erstwhile Talwandi Sabo Power Limited) is one of India's leading private power producers delivering reliable power for a growing economy, that lights homes, touches lives, and drives transformation across the nation. With a total installed thermal power capacity of 4,780 MW, the company supplies power to discoms nationwide through long-term partnerships, while supporting emerging grid requirements. Its portfolio includes a 1,980 MW plant in Mansa, Punjab; a 1,000 MW facility in Nellore, Andhra Pradesh; 1200 MW in Sakti, Chhattisgarh; and a 600 MW unit in Jharsuguda, Odisha. Through operational excellence, technological leadership, and strategic capacity expansion, Vedanta Power Limited is reinforcing grid stability as a cornerstone of India's energy security.

Vedanta Power Limited invites Expression of Interest (EOI) from all users of ash for lifting of fly ash, bottom ash and pond ash on **"free-of-cost", "as is where is basis"** and **"first-come-first-serve basis"**. The ideal user shall be lifting and transporting of ash generated from 600 MW Thermal IPP located in Jharsuguda at their own expenses for utilisation of ash in an environment-friendly manner, as per the prevailing guidelines of MoEF & CC, SPCB and MoP.

*Interested and eligible ash users can download the bidding documents from:
www.vedantapower.com/becoming-a-supplier/

**Expression of Interest to be submitted by 22nd October 2026, via Email Id:
VedantaPower.Commercial@vedanta.co.in**

For further information, bidders can log in to:
https://www.vedantapower.com/becoming-a-supplier/

Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs
Government of India
एन बी सी सी NBCC
A Navratna CPSE

Sale of Residential Apartments Through e-Auction

Once-in-a-Lifetime Opportunity to Own Your Dream Home at Prime Location

Avenue Towers
THE PINNACLE OF REFINED LIVING

Near Leela Palace Hotel Chanakyapuri, New Delhi

PRICE STARTING FROM ₹ 15.75 CR



Gym | Landscape Terrace | Indoor Games | Outdoor Pool

Scan for location | 4 BHK Residences | Landscaped Greens & Social Spaces | Swimming Pool & Gymnasium | Community Facilities | Sports & Recreation Amenities | Children's Play Area | Library, Reading & Co-working Spaces | Security, Power Backup & Modern Infrastructure | Scan to view brochure

Last Date of receiving EMD: 17.10.2026 | Date of e-Auction: 19.10.2026

RERA Registration Number: DLRERA2026P0010 | Weblink:https://erera.co.in/reradelhiindex/PublicView/RegisteredProjectDetail

NBCC (INDIA) LIMITED
(A Government of India Enterprise)
NBCC Bhawan, Lodhi Road, New Delhi - 110003

Call @ 8168059012, 9899179426, 9289299355, 8527136569, 9811850902, 8527509652, 9560354093
www.nbccindia.in

1,802
CUSTOMERS^

6,979
SUPPLIERS#

26
OWN FACILITIES*

ONE
UNIVERSAL FACTORY

ZETWERK
ZETWERK MANUFACTURING BUSINESSES LIMITED
www.zetwerk.com



We are a technology-led, asset-light manufacturing platform for industrial and consumer goods in India and globally. In Fiscal 2026, our manufacturing platform had a diverse customer base ranging from start-ups to large industrial companies, including 8 of Sensex, 16 of Nifty 50, and 102 of India's Fortune 500 companies. We undertake complex manufacturing across industries including utilities, renewables, consumer electronics, artificial intelligence infrastructure, aerospace, space & defence, oil & gas, and industrial automation.

^In Fiscal 2026 | # Third party suppliers, Fiscal 2026 | *As of June 30, 2026 *Map not to scale, for representation purposes only.*

ZETWERK: END-TO-END MANUFACTURING

ZETWERK MANUFACTURING BUSINESSES LIMITED (formerly known as Zetwerk Manufacturing Businesses Private Limited) is proposing, subject to applicable statutory and regulatory requirements, receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with the Registrar of Companies, Karnataka at Bengaluru, SEBI and the Stock Exchanges on October 11, 2026. The RHP is available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, and is available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE and NSE at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, on the website of our Company at www.zetwerk.com and the websites of the BRLMs, i.e., Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited, Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited, Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited, Avendus Capital Private Limited, JM Financial Limited, HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited and Pantomath Capital Advisors Private Limited at https://investmentbank.kotak.com, www.morganstanley.com/india, www.goldmansachs.com, www.avendus.com, www.jmfl.com, www.business.hsbc.co.in and www.pantomathcapital.com, respectively. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risk, see ***"Risk Factors"*** beginning on page 28 of the RHP. Potential investors should rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved, for making any investment decision.

This announcement does not constitute an invitation or offer of securities for sale in any jurisdiction. The Equity Shares have not been and will not be registered under the United States Securities Act of 1933, as amended (the ***"U.S. Securities Act"***) or any other applicable law of the United States and may not be offered or sold within the United States except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are only being offered and sold (a) to persons in the United States that are reasonably believed to be "qualified institutional buyers" (as defined in Rule 144A under the U.S. Securities Act) in transactions exempt from or not subject to the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act; or (b) outside the United States in offshore transactions in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdictions where those offers and sales occur. There will be no public offering of the Equity Shares in the United States.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | THURSDAY | OCTOBER 15, 2026

SFI, DYFI marches stopped at barricades; Rahul flags assault, FIR lodged

ABHINAV KUMAR JHA
New Delhi

Police barricades halted the Students' Federation of India (SFI) and Democratic Youth Federation of India (DYFI) march on Ferozeshah Road on Wednesday, leaving protesters facing a police line separating them from Jantar Mantar. The students raised their voices, calling for the reclamation of the historic protest site and demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. The march could go no further. Police personnel stopped the group before it could reach its destination.

The confrontation was one of several developments in central Delhi on October 14, as student organisations and opposition-linked groups continued their protests despite restrictions on demonstrations at Jantar Mantar. The day brought another attempted march towards the site, the detention of youth activists, the imprisonment of two Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) leaders, a press conference at which Rahul Gandhi stood alongside student protesters alleging police assault, and the registration of an FIR by Delhi Police in connection with the bus incident.

The immediate focus on Ferozeshah Road was SFI and DYFI activists' attempt to reach Jantar Mantar. Their march targeted the decision to remove the site from the list of designated venues for demonstrations. The groups wanted the venue restored and Gyanesh Kumar to resign.

Slogans such as "Reclaim Jantar Mantar" and "Gyanesh Kumar must resign" made the march's purpose clear. The protesters continued to press their demands after police stopped them at the barricades. They said they would reclaim the site, which they argued should remain accessible to people seeking to organise peaceful demonstrations.

Members of the Indian Youth Congress (IYC) began another march from Patel Chowk Metro station to Jantar Mantar in the afternoon, demanding Kumar's resignation and insisting the protest site be restored. The group set out despite the police restrictions in the area. Police stopped the march, and protesters were detained. The Youth Congress also put up hoardings in central Delhi as it stepped up its campaign against the Chief Election Commissioner.

The day's demonstrations followed a series of flash protests around central Delhi, during which student activists were detained near Connaught Place and other locations. With the main protest site no longer designated for demonstrations, groups tried to mobilise on nearby roads and at metro stations, only to face police deployments and barricades.


Security personnel detain activists of Indian Youth Congress (IYC) during a protest march toward Parliament Street, in New Delhi Wednesday PTI

Away from the barricades, Rahul Gandhi held a press conference on allegations of mistreatment of detained student protesters. The Leader of the Opposition stood alongside members of the National Students' Union of India (NSUI), including women who alleged that police personnel had assaulted them during Tuesday's protest and detention.

Rahul Gandhi paused mid-remark, turned to a young woman beside him, and raised her hands, placing them on the shoulders of fellow protesters. The gesture brought the students gathered around the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha into the centre of a press conference in New Delhi on Wednesday, where accounts of alleged police violence during recent demonstrations were presented alongside demands for accountability.

The young woman, an NSUI activist, was among the protesters who appeared with Gandhi to describe their experiences in police custody. Gandhi introduced her as "our sherni", referring to her alleged assault during the detention of student activists. She maintained that the experience had not intimidated her. The allegations at the briefing targeted Delhi Police personnel involved in detaining protesters during demonstrations against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

Among those introduced was Athira, a Delhi University student from Kerala, who alleged that she had been struck repeatedly while in police custody and had suffered damage to her hearing in one ear. Gandhi cited her case while accusing the authorities of using excessive force against young demonstrators.

Air India flight cleared after hijack alert

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi



An Air India flight operating from Frankfurt to Delhi triggered an anti-hijacking alert after its transponder displayed the emergency code 7500, prompting security protocols and the aircraft's parking in an isolation bay. The airline's engineering team later verified that the alert was triggered inadvertently, and authorities found no actual hijacking threat.

The incident involved Air India flight AI2030, operating on the Frankfurt-Delhi sector with a Boeing 787-9 aircraft registered as VT-TSE. According to the incident report, the aircraft performed a go-around at approximately 9:30 am IST on Wednesday, October 14, before the anti-hijacking alert was communicated to relevant control teams, including Air Traffic Control.

Following the alert, the control room immediately informed the Terminal Control Room Officer. Relevant teams and stakeholders were mobilised in accordance with standard operating procedures, and arrangements were made to park the aircraft in an isolation bay for security-related checks.

After the aircraft was parked, the flight engineer contacted the crew to verify the situation. According to the incident report, the crew said they needed an engineer.

An Air India engineer later clarified that the transponder code had been activated inadvertently due to an error by the transponder operator. The alert was therefore treated as a false alarm, with no actual hijacking threat established during the reported verification.

The incident highlights the importance of promptly responding to aviation security alerts, even when they are later found to have been triggered mistakenly. The 7500 transponder code is internationally recognised as a signal indicating unlawful interference or a hijacking situation, and its activation can trigger immediate security procedures.

In a statement, Air India said flight AI2030, operating from Frankfurt to Delhi, was diverted to Jaipur following a perceived security concern and landed safely.

The airline said the relevant security agencies conducted the necessary checks and cleared the aircraft and crew. All passengers disembarked, underwent security screening, and then reboarded the aircraft.

Air India added that the flight was expected to resume its journey to Delhi shortly after the completion of the required procedures.

The airline also apologised for the inconvenience caused by the disruption, thanking passengers for their patience and understanding. It reiterated that the safety and security of passengers and crew remained its highest priority.

The response involved coordination between the control room, apron control, AOCC, terminal control and other concerned stakeholders. The aircraft's handling at the isolation bay followed standard operating procedures after the alert.

While the initial activation of the 7500 code prompted an anti-hijacking response, the subsequent engineering clarification and security checks indicated that the incident was a false alarm rather than an actual hijacking.

The incident underscores how a mistaken transponder activation can trigger a significant aviation security response, requiring immediate coordination and verification before normal flight operations can resume.

INCIDENT TIMELINE

- 9:18 am: The control room received information about the incident from apron control
- 9:25 am: Apron control contacted the Air India engineer regarding the matter
- 9:30 am: The aircraft performed a go-around, as recorded in the operational message
- 9:32 am: The Airport Operations Control Centre (AOCC) issued an anti-hijacking alert, reporting that flight AI2030 had displayed transponder code 7500

India-US trade deal nears finish line: EAM

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi



India and the United States are continuing negotiations to resolve outstanding differences over a proposed bilateral trade agreement, with talks moving toward a possible "landing point," External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar said ahead of US Secretary of State Marco Rubio's anticipated visit to India.

Speaking at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum on Tuesday evening, Jaishankar said negotiations were progressing but declined to disclose details of the discussions.

"I think we are waiting on a few things. I wouldn't be comfortable spilling the beans in public," he said when asked about the status of the proposed trade deal. Jaishankar said India's Commerce and Industry Minister, the US Trade Representative (USTR), and other officials were discussing how to resolve the remaining differences and move the agreement forward.

"I sense that this is an issue which is heading towards a landing point," he said.

India and the US have been negotiating a bilateral trade agreement since early 2025, seeking to address tariff-related tensions, reduce non-tariff barriers and expand market access. New Delhi seeks more favourable tariff terms for Indian exports than those offered by competing economies.

Jaishankar noted that the outcome would depend not only on the terms India and the US negotiate but also on the agreements Washington reaches with other competing economies. Earlier this month, US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer said the two countries were working to finalise a bilateral trade agreement, though a deal was not imminent. He said both sides had identified the outstanding issues and were working to resolve them.

Jaishankar's remarks came more than a week after Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said negotiations on the trade deal had reached a "plateau". The external affairs minister also discussed Washington's changing approach to global economic engagement, saying the US was seeking to rebuild its manufacturing base and reset the terms of access to its domestic market.

"The US is today determined to re-industrialise and to reset the terms of access to its economy," he said, adding that tariffs were closely linked to these objectives. He noted that major economies around the world were negotiating with Washington in response to its evolving trade policy.

"We're not alone in this. In our case, we are pretty far advanced in that process of negotiation," Jaishankar said.

On the broader bilateral relationship, Jaishankar said the US was reassessing the terms of its alliances and treaty relationships, with the impact being felt particularly in Europe and, to some extent, East Asia. However, he distinguished India's relationship with Washington from formal military alliances, describing the two countries as strategic partners. "We have many issues we are working on with the United States, but we don't have an issue of the terms of alliance because we are not officially an ally," he said.

"India is a country which has a strong strategic partnership with the US, but a strategic partnership is a partnership; it's not an alliance," he added. Jaishankar said India and the US have spent more than two decades identifying areas of convergence, shared interests, and common priorities, and that the fundamental basis of their relationship has not changed.

India-US relations have faced significant strain after Washington imposed punitive tariffs on Indian goods last year. Tensions were also heightened by US President Donald Trump's claims about his role in de-escalating the India-Pakistan military confrontation in May 2025, which drew sharp reactions from Indian officials.

Disputes over US immigration policy and the decision to raise H-1B visa fees have further strained bilateral ties. Washington's move to restrict a key green-card processing programme affecting major global technology companies, including Indian IT firms Tata Consultancy Services and Wipro, has added to the concerns.

FROM PAGE - 1

IDBI set for Fairfax takeover...

The strategic restructuring is part of efforts to build a future-ready financial sector that empowers customers, supports entrepreneurs and contributes to the vision of Viksit Bharat, she added.

Briefing media on the decision, Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said the Government and the Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) will together hold a 34 per cent stake in the restructured entity.

The proposed sale of a combined 60.72 per cent stake held by the Government and the LIC would transfer control of the lender to Fairfax, subject to the completion of the transaction and requisite regulatory approvals.

"The CCEA...approved M/s 10955230 Canada Inc (parent entity M/s Fairfax Financial Holdings Ltd) as the strategic buyer for this transaction for a purchase consideration of `52,877.07 crore for the acquisition of 60.72 per cent stake in IDBI Bank, comprising 30.48 per cent equity held by the GoI and 30.24 per cent by the LIC," the statement said.

Department of Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM) Secretary Arunish Chawla said the deal will be completed before the end of the current fiscal year.

Fairfax will also have to make an open offer to the minority shareholders. Fairfax, which holds a stake in CSB, must either merge it with IDBI Bank or exit the holding within two years.

IDBI Bank Ltd is a scheduled commercial bank regulated by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). Due to its poor financial health, the Bank required repeated infusion of capital, initially provided by the Government of India and later by the LIC.

On 5th May, 2017, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) put the IDBI Bank under the Prompt Corrective Action Framework and imposed several restrictions in view of its non-performing assets and losses incurred by the Bank, an official statement said. After considering the improvement in the Bank's financial health, the RBI later, vide its letter dated 10th March, 2021, lifted the restrictions imposed on the IDBI Bank subject to certain conditions and continuous monitoring.

Against this backdrop, the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) approved the strategic restructuring of IDBI Bank Ltd. In compliance thereof, it was decided that an aggregate 60.72% of the equity stake in the IDBI Bank Ltd. be sold to a Strategic Buyer, of which the GoI share would be 30.48%. The LIC share would be 30.24%, leaving a residual shareholding of 15% with the Government of India and 19% with the LIC.

The decision of the CCEA was implemented through a two-stage, competitive bidding process supported by a multi-layered, collective decision-making mechanism consisting of the Inter-Ministerial Group (IMG), the Core Group of Secretaries on Disinvestment (CGD) and the Alternative Mechanism (AM) consisting of an empowered Group of Cabinet Ministers.

The Preliminary Information Memorandum (PIM), inviting Expressions of Interest (EoI) from all interested parties, was issued on 07.10.2022. Only parties found 'Fit and Proper' by the RBI. They granted security clearance by the Ministry of Home Affairs could participate in the bidding stage, for which the RBI issued a Request for Proposal inviting technical and financial bids from the Qualified Interested Parties (QIPs).

Of the five parties that initially submitted their expression of interest, four qualified as per the eligibility criteria and disqualification conditions prescribed therein; of these, two finally submitted their techno-financial bids. They became Qualified Bidders (QBs) for this transaction.

After comprehensive evaluation by the CGD and after considering the recommendations of the Alternative Mechanism, the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) in its meeting held on 14/10/2026 approved M/s 10955230 Canada Inc. (parent entity M/s Fairfax Financial Holdings Ltd.) as the Strategic Buyer for this transaction for a purchase consideration of `52,878.0806181 crores.

In such transactions, there is no a priori benchmark for bidding. The bidders do their own valuation and submit their bids in sealed envelopes confidentially. Independent agencies are hired to conduct a fair valuation of the enterprise contemporaneously, which is then used as a comparator to assess the reasonableness of the submitted bids.

Two CJP leaders in judicial custody

"The past conduct of both accused persons shows that they violated the lawful directions of the authorities. The present conduct of both accused persons shows that they are likely to breach peace and tranquillity in the area. From the material on record, it is imperative that the above-said respondents, after having executed a bond/bail bond for keeping the peace in pursuance of an order of a SEM South West under Section 136 BNSS, have again committed breach of the bond/bail bond, which is evident from their conduct/social media posts and the statement of the complainant.

Thus, I, Mahesh Kumar Meena, SEM, New Delhi, am satisfied that sufficient grounds exist to proceed against the respondents.

According to police, the Special Executive Magistrate sent Das and Ranka to Tihar jail for five days after considering the kalandra (preventive police report) details, their repeated violations of the law, and the serious apprehension that, if released on bail, they would violate the law again and instigate others. They were produced before the Special Executive Magistrate on Wednesday morning. The CJP leaders were detained early Tuesday after they, along with 11 other activists, allegedly breached barricades and entered the Jantar Mantar area without authorisation, raised slogans against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, and erected a national flag there.

Police said Das and Ranka, who were detained on Saturday as well, had signed bonds to maintain peace for a year. The action against the CJP leaders comes amid heightened security in the national Capital following a series of protests held by the youth-led outfit and other organisations demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls.

Condemning the arrest of CJP leaders for trying to enter the Jantar Mantar protest site, Rahul Gandhi, Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, said on Wednesday that waving the Tricolour at Jantar Mantar in a peaceful protest is "not a crime".

"Jailing youth for it is an act of cowardice. Students. Youth. Journalists. The INDIA bloc. Different banners, one cause. All protests are one: citizens demanding their constitutional rights. Jantar Mantar belongs to the people of India. We will reclaim it," Gandhi said in a post on X. And CJP leader Abhijeet Dipke replied, "Thank you, LoP @RahulGandhi sir, for speaking out against the illegal arrest of @Ashutosh Ranka & @Saurav Das." The post marks a major shift in the Congress's stance on the CJP, sparked by a social media trend in May. Voices in the main Opposition party were initially skeptical of the CJP, which led to the 17-day demonstration against paper leaks at Jantar Mantar in July.

In a statement, Delhi Police said that on the morning of October 13, Saurav Das, Ashutosh Ranka, Ajinkya Shinde, and 11 other CJP members entered Jantar Mantar, a denotified designated protest site, by trespassing through a private premise.

"Police personnel deployed at the spot intervened and attempted to stop them. However, the protesters allegedly obstructed police personnel in the discharge of their official duties," the statement said.

All 14 persons were detained, and an FIR was registered against them at Connaught Place Police Station under Sections 223a (disobedience to an order duly promulgated by a public servant), 332 (house-trespass to commit an offence) and 61(2) (criminal conspiracy) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita on October 13 and another FIR was filed at the Parliament Street Police Station under Sections 221 (obstructing a public servant in discharge of his public functions), 115(2) (voluntarily causing hurt), 132 (assault or criminal force to deter public servant from discharge of his duty), 121(1) (voluntarily causing hurt or grievous hurt to deter public servant from his duty) and 3(5) (common intention), the police statement said. Sections 332, 132 and 121(1) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita are non-bailable offences. In view of their alleged attempts to disturb public peace and violate the law, Das, Ranka, and Shinde were arrested under the relevant preventive provisions of law, the statement said.

"Their alleged attempts to instigate others through social media to engage in similar unlawful activities were also taken into consideration. The three individuals were produced before the Special Executive Magistrate, where proceedings under Sections 126 and 170 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita were initiated," it added.

The Special Executive Magistrate court sent Das and Ranka to jail for five days and bound down Shinde to maintain peace and good behaviour for six months, they said.

CJP is AAP's 'B' team: CM Rekha

The chief minister also accused the AAP, Congress, and other Opposition parties of troubling Delhi through protests and sit-in, calling them "dharna kings" who can't see a bright future for themselves in politics.

She highlighted the financial strain on Delhi traders from recurring demonstrations during the festive season, noting that designated sites like Ramlila Maidan and Burari Ground are available. "Delhi has suffered losses worth thousands of crores of rupees today. Traders are distressed, and the public is suffering. This is solely because of them. Why do you want to stage sit-ins and protests? You want to oppose the functioning of a democracy simply because you failed to form the government. I want to ask... if you form the Government in Tamil Nadu or Kerala, will such an exercise not take place there? Does this issue concern you only in states where you have failed to form the government? Where does this CJP go when issues arise in those states? Why doesn't it go there to stage protests, the chief minister said, while criticising the Congress and other opposition leaders.

She also questioned why the CJP members had not gone to Punjab amid concerns over the drug menace in the state. "Why isn't your focus on Punjab? Just yesterday, a murder took place in the state. Drug rackets are operating there. Why is the CJP not going there? The CJP is working as AAP's B party and pursuing only its agenda," the chief minister said. Activist Parvinder Singh alias Jhota, known for raising his voice against drug abuse and the illegal sale of addictive substances at chemist shops, was shot dead in broad daylight in a busy market in Punjab's Mansa district on October 13

Questioning the AAP over its opposition to the SIR, the chief minister said the party had not raised objections when it came to power in Delhi following the previous revision exercise but had now resorted to protests after losing public support.

The chief minister said the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls was not the first time in the country. "Delhi witnessed an SIR in 2002. The Congress was in power at the Centre at the time. Yet, did Congress win even a single seat in Delhi after 2015? Was the SIR the reason for that? The public has completely rejected Congress, and that is the reason for these parties' resentment," the CM said.

She also slammed the CJP's insistence on protesting at Jantar Mantar, which has recently been denotified as a designated protest site, saying that they were bent on troubling Delhi people and "destroying" the city.

She said the Congress and other organisations, in collusion, feel rejected by the people after electoral losses because the public is satisfied with the Modi Government's development work and the country's progress. She said Delhi suffered losses amounting to thousands of crores of rupees, and traders and ordinary people were harassed because of the protests.

Paneer or fake? Delhi HC seeks Centre, FSSAI stand

The petitioners contended that a person consuming a paneer-based product in a hotel or restaurant has no way of knowing whether the dish is prepared with actual paneer or a dairy analogue. They sought urgent directions from the court in view of the festive season, asserting that the authorities should undertake sampling and testing of paneer and products represented as paneer in the market.

"They are doing it; they have placed the statistics (before us) to that effect," the bench responded. The plea said that Gujarat, Punjab, Chhattisgarh and Maharashtra have already taken steps against non-dairy paneer.

It sought directions to the authorities to prevent the manufacture, supply, sale, or service of dairy-analogue paneer in the Capital.

It also prayed for directions to the authorities to ensure that hotels, restaurants, caterers, eateries, cloud kitchens, and e-commerce food businesses clearly disclose the use of analogue/non-dairy substitutes in their food.

"A consumer who knowingly purchases a product correctly disclosed as an analogue or non-dairy substitute makes an informed choice. However, a consumer who purchases or orders 'paneer' is entitled to receive a product that meets the statutory description of paneer and should not be unknowingly supplied a product in which essential milk constituents have been replaced with vegetable fat, vegetable oil, or other non-milk constituents," the petition said.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | THURSDAY | OCTOBER 15, 2026

Hyderabad construction firm alleges Revanth Reddy demanding commission for projects

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Hyderabad/New Delhi

A leading Hyderabad-based construction company, RVM Constructions India Limited, has levelled serious allegations against Telangana Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy over irregularities in the evaluation of tenders floated by Hyderabad Growth Corridor Limited (HGCL) for the construction of Radial Road-2 in the State Capital.

The company alleged that Revanth Reddy demanded a 15 per cent commission from contractors to award projects. In a letter to the president and members of the Builders Association of India (BAI), Nama Ramesh, Managing Director of RVM Constructions India Limited, flagged alleged irregularities in the tendering process and sought the association's intervention.

"It is widely reported that Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy has demanded a commission of 15 per cent for awarding these projects to contractors. It is an open secret, yet no MLA or Minister is speaking about it. It is further alleged that bill payments are being released only to those contractors who pay commissions," Ramesh alleged.

Pointing out that nearly ₹20,000 crore was due to contractors in Telangana against certified bills, some of which had remained unpaid for the past three years, he alleged that substantial commissions were reportedly being demanded for the release of payments.

"Many contractors are suffering because of these delays; some have lost their lives, and many others have lost hope despite repeated requests for payment. If this continues, there will hardly be any contractors left in Telangana," he stated in a letter to BAI. Nama Ramesh sought BAI's intervention and urged the association to take up the issue with the state government.

Meanwhile, the controversy over alleged irregularities in the Radial Road-2 tenders surfaced after Sushee Infra, a company linked to Congress MLA Komatireddy Rajagopal Reddy's family, approached the High Court, challenging HGCL's decision to disqualify it during the technical evaluation without citing adequate reasons. HGCL invited


Telangana Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy

tenders for the construction of Radial Road-2, an 81-km road connecting the Outer Ring Road (ORR) at Budwel with NH-167N at Nacharam near Kodangal.

The project has been divided into three packages, with an estimated cost of ₹3,295 crore. In his letter to BAI, Nama Ramesh said leading companies, including NCC, BVSR, and GKC, participated in the tendering process along with Sushee Infra. "From the manner in which the evaluation was conducted, it appears that Sushee Infra was deliberately targeted," he alleged.

Ramesh further alleged that the Chief Minister's Office had threatened contractors and discouraged them from participating in the bidding process for Radial Road-2.

"Over the last five to six years, I have observed that at least 10-12 companies typically participate in EPC or HAM projects tendered by the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH), the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) and state governments. In these tenders, however, only four bidders participated, and the remaining bidders are understood to be companies pre-arranged with the Chief Minister. It is learnt that other contractors who intended to bid received threatening phone calls from the Chief Minister's Office. Sushee Infra was the only company that ventured to participate," he said.

Ramesh also said that Sushee Infra had alleged that, during the bidding process, it received calls from HGCL officials and others asking it not to participate in the tender. The company was allegedly warned that it would otherwise be disqualified without any valid reason.

"As is widely known, there is a political rift between Rajagopal Reddy and Revanth Reddy. Since Sushee Infra belongs to Rajagopal Reddy's family, the Chief Minister allegedly influenced HGCL to disqualify the company. To date, HGCL has not disclosed the L1 bidder's financial bid. Sushee Infra has stated that the current L1 bidders have quoted approximately 3 to 15 per cent above the estimated cost. This shows a clear lack of transparency in the process and raises serious concerns that the award is being finalised under political influence," Ramesh alleged.

He further stated that Sushee Infra had submitted bids for all three packages and claimed that its quoted prices were significantly lower than those of the current L1 bidders. According to the company, the total difference amounted to approximately ₹600 crore compared with the tendered value, he added. Ramesh said the potential savings would have benefited Telangana residents and the state's development.

ED flags 20-fold land flip, seeks FIR against PCA over alleged conspiracy and cheating

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi/Chandigarh

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has asked Punjab Police to register an FIR over the Punjab Cricket Association's (PCA) land purchases, declaring that prima facie cognisable offences of criminal conspiracy and cheating were committed.

In a letter dated October 12 to Mohali SSP Varun Sharma under Section 66(2) of the PMLA, the agency said the Punjab Cricket Association (PCA) flipped land bought cheaply from farmers within months at multiples of the original price.

Between August and November 2025, two real estate developers bought agricultural land in Bhalla village (Ajnala, Amritsar) for around ₹15 lakh per acre. On 16th Feb 2026, they sold it to the PCA (linked to the BCCI) for nearly ₹3 crore per acre (almost 20 times the purchase price). The association bought around 19.5 acres for a sports complex and



paid a total of ₹58.22 crore.

AGM Heights Pvt Ltd and Future Homes bought about 35.64 acres from farmers for ₹ 6.92 crore. AGM Heights purchased around 7.63 acres for ₹1.36 crore, while Future Homes bought about 28 acres for ₹5.56 crore. They later sold 19.5 acres to the PCA for ₹58.22 crore. According to the ED, the same developers sold land in the village in July 2026 for only ₹31-33 lakh per acre.

The Amritsar land deals are part of nearly ₹78 crore in total transactions. In Bathinda, the PCA paid Darshan Singh about ₹19.77 crore for 100 kanal and 10 marla, which is about 3.93 times the official collector rate of ₹5 lakh per kanal. This was the highest price paid for any single deal in the area during 2024-25.

The letter states that several individuals and companies bought land and sold it to the PCA only a few months later at much higher prices. It alleges this is criminal conspiracy and cheating under Sections 61(2) and 318(4) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS). The letter also accuses the registered society of misusing its funds by overpaying for land, then withdrawing cash and transferring it to private individuals and companies after the association paid for the land.

According to the timeline, the PCA's top committee met on August 2, 2025, to discuss buying land for a stadium. Five days later, Future Homes purchased a large plot. The association published a public advertisement on August 20, and after that, companies bought more land. On February 16, 2026, AGM Heights, a company founded in 2023 with little capital, and Future Homes sold the land to the PCA.

The Punjab and Haryana High Court is now handling the case after former first-class cricketer Rakesh Handa filed a petition. He has raised concerns about irregularities in the Bathinda and Amritsar land deals and questioned whether all required approvals were obtained.

PCA president Amarjeet Singh Mehta says the land was bought after a public advertisement and that any landowner could have sold it.

J&K, Ladakh HC questions Govt accommodation for Ghulam Nabi Azad, Ravinder Raina till March 2027

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Jammu

A Division Bench of the High Court of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh, comprising Chief Justice Pushpendra Singh Bhati and Justice Rajesh Sekhri, on Wednesday questioned the Union Territory administration on the policy that allowed two political leaders, Ghulam Nabi Azad and Ravinder Raina, to continue occupying Government accommodation until March 2027.

Hearing a PIL filed by Professor SK Bhalla on October 12, a division bench also sought clarity on the policy governing Government accommodation for political leaders in Jammu and Kashmir.

Appearing for the UT administration, senior additional advocate general Monika Kohli told the court that a designated committee considered the cases of former CM Ghulam Nabi Azad and Raina, former president of the J&K BJP, at a meeting on August 14. Kohli submitted



that the committee recommended continuing the allotments for both leaders.

Kohli told the bench that the recommendations were subsequently placed before the competent authority, which, after due consideration, permitted them to retain the residential accommodations until March 2027 or until the next review, whichever is earlier.

The bench, however, sought an explanation regarding the policy governing such allotments, asking Kohli about the rules under which the designated committee exercises its powers to permit political leaders to retain Government accommodation.

"This court, on such submissions, has posed a question to learned senior AAG, as to what is the policy in the UT of Jammu and Kashmir, which governs the retention of Government accommodation... and from where the designated committee derives its power to consider whether such Government accommodation has to be retained by the political persons," the bench asked.

Kohli sought time to file an appropriate affidavit and assist the court on the issue of a uniform policy applicable to political persons retaining Government accommodation. Allowing her request, the court posted the matter for November 12.

During the hearing, conducted virtually because the bench is presently based in Srinagar, the petitioner's counsel argued that unauthorised occupation of Government accommodation could not be justified on security grounds.

The petitioner's counsel, senior advocates SS Ahmad and Supriya Chauhan, referred to an order dated December 26, 2022, in which a division bench declined to protect certain persons from eviction from Government properties on security grounds, citing Supreme Court and Delhi High Court judgments to support their submission.

The PIL, filed by Bhalla in 2020, previously led to the eviction of more than 180 politicians from Government accommodations following the 2018 Assembly dissolution and subsequent High Court intervention.

Meerut court awards death penalty to Muskan Rastogi, Sahil Shukla in blue drum murder case

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Meerut

A district court in Meerut on Wednesday sentenced Muskan Rastogi and her partner Sahil Shukla to death for the murder of her husband, merchant navy officer Saurabh Rajput. The body had been dismembered and sealed with cement inside a blue drum, a detail that made the case one of the most widely discussed murders in western Uttar Pradesh over the past year.

District Judge Arvind Kumar Mishra delivered the judgment after a 13-month trial with 126 hearings. It's the so-called 'blue drum case', and the two convicts appeared via video conference.

Rajput was killed on March 3, 2025. His remains were discovered roughly two weeks later at the house the couple occupied in Meerut. Investigators found that the body had been cut into pieces, placed inside a large blue drum, and covered with cement in an apparent attempt to hide the evidence. The grisly method of concealment, combined with the ordinary domestic setting in which the remains were found, kept the case in national headlines long after the initial discovery.

On 30th September, the same court found Muskan and Sahil guilty of murder and of attempting to conceal the body. The death sentence passed on



Wednesday was in accordance with that finding. Senior Jail Superintendent Dr Viresh Raj Sharma said the two convicts had been restless in the days before the hearing, had eaten very little, and had not slept well.

Before handing down the sentence, Judge Mishra asked both whether they wished to make any statement about the sentence. He also asked several questions about the case, including the forensic report. The hearing was very brief. Sharma declined to disclose the exact questions asked of the convicts.

Muskan has two daughters, one seven years old and the other ten months old. In the three or four days before sentencing, she requested permission on several occasions to see her older daughter. The younger daughter has been with her in jail, and Muskan has spoken of her concern for the future of that child. The court produced the two convicts separately for the hearing.

Saurabh Rajput's mother, Renu, was in court with his aunt, brother, and several other family members when the court passed the sentence. Before the verdict, Renu said the family had done everything possible at every level to get justice for Saurabh. She thanked the administration and everyone else who had stood by them throughout the process.

The Prosecution had 22 witnesses. Some of them were people who had been involved in the purchase of the blue drum, the knife and the other materials which were alleged to have been used in the crime. Hotel staff and cab drivers were also called to establish the accused's movements at the time of the killing and at the time of the concealment of the body. Those accounts, together with the forensic evidence, were the basis of the case which the court accepted.

CBI files supplementary chargesheet in NEET-UG paper leak, no official named

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi

The CBI filed a supplementary chargesheet in the NEET UG 2026 paper leak case with the Delhi court on Wednesday. The CBI claims the conspiracy involved private individuals, experts, intermediaries, and people linked to coaching centres, and names one more private individual, while again stating that no government or NTA officer has been named in the case.

People close to the investigation say the filing effectively closes the inquiry into the leak. "No Government official has been named," one officer said. A second officer confirmed that the investigation was carried out to determine whether NTA or any other Government official was involved, "but no such involvement was found."

The supplementary chargesheet filed before Special Judge Ajay Gupta names Sheshrav Bajrang Suryawanshi (alias Raj Suryawanshi), of Nanded, Maharashtra, as the 14th accused. He was arrested on 2nd September and is alleged to have conspired with co-accused Shubham Khairnar to give the leaked medical entrance exam paper to the candidates and



take money from their parents. He is alleged to have asked the candidates to gather at a place in Nanded, given them the paper, and kept the candidates' original documents (i.e., certificates, identity cards, etc.) so he could demand payment from them after the exam.

The court has directed that a copy of the chargesheet be furnished to the accused's counsel, and the matter is listed for further hearing on 15th October. This follows the first chargesheet filed on 28th July, which named 13 persons, three of whom were the subject experts engaged by the NTA: Manisha Gurunath Mandhare (Botany and Zoology), Prahlad Vithalrao Kulkarni (Chemistry) and Manisha Sanjay Havaldar (Physics).

The others were the intermediaries and representatives of the coaching institutes. The first chargesheet left the role of the other alleged conspirators open until the forensic reports were in; the additional document incorporates findings from the Central Forensic Science Laboratory, the Government Examiner of Questioned Documents, and experts from Delhi University.

The case arose from the NEET-UG exam on May 3. The NTA cancelled the exam on May 12 after it found that at least 120 questions in a 'guess paper' (a paper put together by subject experts and teachers to predict likely questions) matched the actual paper. This led to massive protests, a major row in Parliament and the resignation of then Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan. A re-exam was subsequently held.

The CBI probe traced the leak to the paper setting and translation process. The CBI found that the three NTA-contracted experts abused their access in various ways.

One of them wrote the questions on chits; the others memorised them and then transcribed or marked the relevant portions of the textbooks, which a network of intermediaries across multiple states then passed on for money.

The CBI raided several states, collected digital evidence such as deleted chats and PDFs, and relied on hundreds of witnesses and documents. The charges include criminal conspiracy, cheating, criminal breach of trust, and destroying evidence under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, as well as sections of the Prevention of Corruption Act and the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024.

Didi is with you, for you always: Mamata tells CJP



SAUGAR SENGUPTA
Kolkata

Even as the former Bengal Chief Minister on Wednesday expressed her "strong solidarity" with arrested CJP leaders Saurav Das and Asutosh Ranka, condemning their arrest by the Delhi Police and promising to stand by them for all time to come, the Left and the Congress came down heavily on her, questioning her "conspicuous absence from the grand march to the Supreme Court" as well as the rally that her party in Kolkata organised on Tuesday.

"She went to Delhi, and after offering some photo sessions she suddenly vanished... skipped the grand march to the Supreme Court ... at least she was not seen there... then again she was not to be seen in Tuesday's anti-CEC rally in Kolkata," CPI(M) leader Satarup Ghosh said, adding a senior leader like her should shun hypocrisy.

Reminding how the Trinamool Congress chief had ditched the UPA alliance in the 2019 general elections and how "she had always tried to backstab the Congress Party," PCC leader Soumya Banerjee asked why "Mamata Banerjee herself gave a call for an anti-CEC procession in Kolkata and in the final moment backed out, leaving the citadel in the hands of other leaders like Dola Sen and Kunal Ghosh," wondering whether she did not want to rub the Apex Court the wrong way as there were several lawsuits she was fighting up there.

Meanwhile, Banerjee on Wednesday attacked the powers that be for trying to "intimidate" the younger generation by its oppressive policies.

CM Adhikari vows to convert West Bengal from *Bhatta Nirbhar* to *Atma Nirbhar*

SAUGAR SENGUPTA
Kolkata

The West Bengal BJP Government had charted a plan to transform the State from the present Bhatta Nirbhar (dole-dependent) to Atma Nirbhar (self-reliant) region, Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Wednesday said, adding that a designated group of ministers had submitted a draft industrial policy covering the future industrial roadmap and land policy that would be unveiled soon for the benefit of prospective investors.

Speaking at the inauguration of a Rs 6,000 crore chemical complex by AdPerMa Private Limited, a wholly owned subsidiary of Haldia Petrochemicals Limited, the Chief Minister said his Government was determined to create a business-friendly climate that militant trade unionism and flawed policies of the preceding Left and Trinamool Congress Governments had destroyed.

"We are determined to bring back the healthy industrial climate" for which a


Bengal CM Suvendu Adhikari in conversation with TCG Chairman Purnendu Chatterjee during the inauguration of Adperma Private Limited phenol and acetone manufacturing plantin Purba Medinipur district on Wednesday PTI

new industrial policy detailing investment incentives, land allocation and power tariff plans would be unveiled before Diwali, the Chief Minister said.

"We will not do a few things that the previous governments did," he said, accusing the Marxist and the Mamata Banerjee governments. "Trade unions, strikes and assault on the management led to the closure of 50,000 industries in Bengal," he said, adding, "we are determined to stop this and create the best investment climate in the State."

Speaking after the inauguration of the chemical plant, he said the new phenol acetone facility would end India's dependence on imports. "I am immensely pleased and proud to inaugurate India's largest integrated phenol and acetone plant by... this state-of-the-art facility will open new horizons for industrial growth and employment generation across the State," Adhikari said, reminding how it would provide strength to Prime Minister Narendra Modi's Atma Nirbhar Bharat initiative besides navigating Bengal to economic self-reliance.

"My Government remained steadfast in its commitment to the comprehensive development of Bengal, the construction of modern infrastructure and the advancement of Industrialization," he said, laying stress on an economic ecosystem that revolved on self-reliance rather than economic doles.

The Chief Minister also announced that a Pepsi manufacturing plant and a medical equipment manufacturing unit would come up around Haldia. The projects were likely to benefit the people of Bengal in general, and the residents of Nandigram in particular, immensely.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | THURSDAY | OCTOBER 15, 2026

Editor's TAKE

Kalam's unfinished dream: A developed India

On World Students' Day, Kalam's legacy goes beyond missiles; it lies in his enduring faith in young minds and his vision of a developed India

Every October 15, classrooms across India fill with quizzes, speeches and posters. It is the birthday of the "People's President", celebrated as World Students' Day. Avul Pakir Jainulabdeen Abdul Kalam, born on 15 October 1931, was indeed a president unlike any other. He rose through the ranks, sold newspapers in his childhood and, through sheer grit and determination, went on to become the 'Missile Man of India' and then the country's President.

The day is often described wrongly, so a correction belongs here. The day has not been declared by the United Nations, but it is celebrated in India as Students' Day. No resolution created it. A grateful country did, because Kalam had earned it. Tamil Nadu goes further and observes the date as Youth Renaissance Day. Why students? Because Kalam never stopped being one, and never stopped being a teacher. As President from 2002 to 2007, he met students constantly, and he kept doing so after leaving office.

He returned to the classroom as a visiting professor at the IIMs in Ahmedabad, Indore and Shillong. On July 27, 2015, he collapsed while lecturing IIM Shillong students on creating a livable planet and died soon after, aged 83. He was teaching until his last hour. The nation's debt to him is larger than the classroom.

As Project Director of SLV-III, India's first satellite launch vehicle designed and produced at home, he helped put the Rohini satellite into orbit in July 1980 and bring India into the select circle of space-faring nations. At the DRDO, he led the Integrated Guided Missile Development Programme, which delivered Agni and Prithvi and earned him the name "Missile Man". He then played a central scientific and technical role in the Pokhran-II tests of May 1998, which made India a declared nuclear-weapon state. Every Indian who sleeps behind a credible deterrent owes him a quiet thank-you. The honours followed: the Padma Bhushan in 1981, the Padma Vibhushan in 1990 and the Bharat Ratna in 1997.

Yet his most lasting work may be the one that carried no title. Wings of Fire, published in 1999, gave millions of young Indians a story in which a modest background was no barrier to ambition. India 2020 gave them a target to build towards. His vision aimed at a developed India by 2020. That year has passed, and the work is unfinished. Kalam would have been the last person to call this an embarrassment.

He would have called it homework. So the best way to mark October 15, is not with garlands. It is with better questions in classrooms, better laboratories in universities and more students who believe, as he did, that a dream is a plan waiting for effort. India gave Kalam its highest civilian honour. The least it owes him in return is a generation that finishes what he started.

Nepal's democracy: Can algorithms rewrite history?

Nepal's demand for generational change raises a deeper question: are democratic institutions being renewed or reduced to narratives amplified by digital platforms? The challenge is to embrace change without erasing history, weakening institutional accountability or confusing online visibility with democratic legitimacy



NAVITA SRIKANT



The Nepali Congress is not merely another political party; it is part of Nepal's democratic heritage, shaped by decades of political struggle, sacrifice, imprisonment and democratic movements. Its history is inseparable from Nepal's democratic journey. What is unfolding therefore deserves examination beyond an ordinary contest among leaders and factions.

Can a country's democratic journey be overwritten by the politics of the algorithm?

The Nepali Congress must renew itself. Democratic institutions cannot remain frozen in time; generational change is necessary, leadership must be accountable, and parties must respond to changing aspirations. But renewal is not erasure. Sher Bahadur Deuba cannot constitutionally seek a third term as party president. Any capable leader, from any generation, who believes they can lead the party forward should make their case. Constitutional processes and party representatives must determine its future, not the personalisation of generational transition.

The question is not which leader should remain or make way, but whether leadership claims are judged by institutional merit, democratic principles and the capacity to serve Nepal's future. Change must be judged by what it improves, not simply by whom it replaces.

The question goes beyond the Nepali Congress

Are we renewing institutions, or simply replacing the people inside them?

Nepal's proposed changes to the bureaucracy, lateral entry into specialised positions, retirement and service tenure, and diplomatic appointments may legitimately seek expertise and fresh thinking. But public servants need leaders who respect experience, invest in human capital and give them space to speak up. If the State demands agency, it must provide the authority and institutional space it requires.

Merit must prevail over conflicts of interest. Wider expertise in diplomacy can be valuable, just as deploying the Army in a genuine emergency may be necessary. But emergency deployment does not automatically justify permanent military management of civilian economic functions. Wider diplomatic recruitment should expand competence without weakening professional standards.

Put the right institution, expertise and accountability behind every public responsibility.

Institutional Signalling: A test of institutional renewal

Institutional accountability also depends on how State power is exercised when consequential questions are sub judice.

Court proceedings do not automatically freeze political or organisational action, but the eventual judicial outcome cannot be ignored. Where the Supreme Court remains seized of a consequential question, those involved must recognise that their actions may have implications for the judicial process.

The reported incident of former Chief Justice Cholendra Shumsher Rana being taken from his residence at midnight raises a broader question: how should State power be exercised when institutional confidence is at stake?

The Executive exercises power, the Legislature scrutinises it, the Judiciary independently reviews it, while the media and civil society expose matters requiring public scrutiny. No one is above the law, but the exercise of State power must preserve institutional confidence and judicial independence.

Democracy is protected when each of its pillars can perform its constitutional function without fear of the others.

And then comes the algorithm

Institutional accountability depends not only on how power is exercised, but also on how political responsibility is assigned. Nepal's post-September 2025 political discourse deserves closer examination.

A reading of Nepali media before and after the upheaval reveals a pattern worth questioning: the demand for generational change became increasingly associated with Nepali Congress leader Sher Bahadur Deuba.

This is not to suggest that Deuba was the only senior leader criticised, or that criticism of him lacked justification. The September uprising challenged an established political generation represented by Deuba, KP Sharma Oli, Pushpa Kamal Dahal (Prachanda) and Dr Baburam Bhattarai. Yet subsequent discourse increasingly concentrated political renewal on the Nepali Congress and, more specifically, Deuba.

Prachanda, Oli and other established leaders remained part of the political process around the March 2026 general election. Dr Bhattarai initially filed his nomination but subsequently withdrew it.

Why, then, did the wider burden of decades of political governance appear increasingly concentrated on one party and one individual?

This is where the algorithm matters.

Digital platforms do not create every grievance, nor does their influence invalidate genuine public anger. But amplification can determine which grievances dominate, whose accountability receives sustained attention and which complexities disappear. "Old leader must go" is easily circulated; examining institutional failures, multiple political actors' responsibilities and the reforms needed to prevent recurrence is harder.

The danger is not criticism of established leaders, but the narrowing of accountability into a personalised narrative: one leader represents an era, one party the establishment, and one generation the explanation for failures with multiple political authors.

Visibility is not proof of representativeness; repetition is not evidence of consensus. Political responsibility must be assessed against conduct, decisions and outcomes-not the intensity with which a narrative is amplified.

Nepal is neither anti-youth nor anti-reform, and it should not be anti-technology. Young leadership can bring new ideas, institutional reform can correct outdated systems, and digital platforms can widen participation. But democratic renewal requires scrutiny of political narratives as well as political actors.

Who shapes Nepal's political memory: institutions that carry democratic experience across generations, or narratives that digital platforms amplify today?

Factional politics and the weight of history

These questions are especially consequential within the Nepali Congress. Its democratic inheritance is not threatened by internal competition alone, but by the possibility that factional advantage may take precedence over institutional renewal. Factional politics is not new to the party. Its history includes divisions, rival leadership claims and competing political agendas. Such contestation is not inherently undemocratic; factions can challenge entrenched leadership and offer alternatives. The test is whether they strengthen internal democracy or reduce the institution to a contest for control.

Uncertainty surrounds the competing factions, their claims and the eventual course of their conventions. The question is not simply who prevails, but whether the process strengthens the party's credibility, respects democratic procedures and prepares it to serve Nepal's future.

No faction can claim the party's legacy exclusively. Nor should generational change become a justification for replacing one concentration of influence with another. Leadership renewal must improve accountability, broaden participation and strengthen the institution beyond individual fortunes.

History will judge every faction by its conduct: whether it protects democratic processes and advances Nepal's democratic future, or deepens divisions and weakens the institution for immediate political advantage.

The Nepali Congress carries a responsibility beyond its internal contests. Its legacy was built through a wider democratic struggle; its future depends on whether it continues to advance that journey.

Renewal without amnesia

The challenge is not to preserve the past unchanged, but to ensure that change does not erase the institutional experience from which Nepal's democracy emerged. The Nepali Congress must renew its leadership and structures without allowing its history to become collateral damage in a contest for organisational control. Nepal need not choose between continuity and change. It can reform institutions while retaining the experience, constitutional principles and accountability that give them legitimacy.

Across political parties, the civil service, diplomacy, the security establishment and democracy's four pillars, renewal should strengthen institutions, prioritise competence and ensure accountability rather than unchecked discretion.

Tools and technologies will evolve; political generations will change. What must endure is merit, institutional integrity and public service.

There is no shortcut to democratic legitimacy and no substitute for public service on the ground. Virality is not constitutional legitimacy. Digital mobilisation cannot replace the everyday work of serving citizens.

Can Nepal modernise its democracy without allowing the algorithms of the present to overwrite the democratic history that made that democracy possible?

The writer is a financial, geopolitical and security analyst and India-Nepal Relations Observer

Daiv Vani

WISDOM FOR A MEANINGFUL LIFE

The Battle Fought Only Within

Navaratri also carries the reminder that our fiercest battles are rarely against others.

Mahishasura, a demon who could not be defeated by any male god, having secured that particular boon through years of penance, terrorized the heavens until the combined energies of all the gods converged into a single, radiant being, Durga, who alone possessed the power to end his reign. It was not brute strength that made her invincible, but the unification of scattered powers into one focused will. Each god gave something of his own: Shiva his trident, Vishnu his discus, and the mountains the lion she rode. None of them alone could have ended Mahishasura; together they became a force he had never planned for. Her victory is a picture of what undivided attention can do.

Mahishasura's boon reveals his real flaw. He had prepared for every threat he could imagine, except the one born of unity itself. His downfall came from what he underestimated, not what he failed to guard against.

We often scatter our own energy across many small distractions, worries, ambitions, comparisons, weakening ourselves against challenges that require our full, undivided strength to overcome. Exhaustion and indecision rarely come from one great enemy. They come from many small ones pulling us in different directions.

This Navaratri, identify one area of your life where your energy feels fragmented, and consciously bring it together, like the gods once did, into a single, focused resolve. –DAIV

PIC TALK



A man navigates a small wooden boat through a pond to harvest lotus flowers during the festive season, in Nadia district, West Bengal. PHOTO: PTI

The mind as medicine



RAJYOGI BRAHMA KUMAR NIKUNJ JI

2ND OPINION



Today, medical professionals all over the world have accepted the fact that diseases such as diabetes, coronary artery disease and hypertension are the result of poor lifestyles, mental stress and tension. Hence, they are now advising less dependence on medicines and emphasising exercise and dietary control to maintain physical health. Medical research has found that almost 85 per cent of all diseases are psychosomatic in nature, ie they originate in negative mental states. Therefore, to nip the evil in the bud, it is important to tackle the malady at the level of the mind, and that involves checking and changing our patterns of thought.

Research has shown that positive thoughts sustained over a long period produce positive health effects, while negative thoughts ultimately lead to diseases. In that case, it is necessary for us to give our minds a positive direction so that we can remain happy and healthy. Having control over our thoughts means having the ability to take the mind where we want, keep it there for as long as we want and withdraw it at will. Practising this frequently, starting with even a few seconds at first, will gradually give us more control over the mind. It will also reduce waste thoughts, which consume a lot of our time and energy.

While this is a rudimentary exercise to improve our concentration, gaining mastery over the mind requires some spiritual knowledge and practice. For this, first of all, we need to understand that we are souls and not bodies. The brain, which is part of the physical body, is merely the hardware that enables the soul to control the body.

The spiritual exercise of the mind involves taking the mind out of the physical body and remaining in an eternal state of being a soul, i.e. a sentient point of light and power. Along with this exercise, one also needs to have a proper mental diet in the form of pure thoughts that are necessary to keep the mind healthy. On the other hand, waste thoughts deplete mental energy and leave us weak. Negative thoughts are like poison and damage mental health, eroding our ability to make sound judgements, take correct decisions, tolerate negative situations or face adversity. Such thoughts arise from body-consciousness but are rooted in the soul in the form of vices such as lust, anger, greed, attachment and ego. We must understand that the most elevated thoughts arise in a state of meditation, when the soul establishes a loving mental link with the Supreme Source, who is the Father of all souls. It is through this divine connection that true healing begins, not just of the body or the mind, but of the soul itself.

When our inner world is aligned with purity, peace and purpose, the outer world begins to reflect that harmony. A healthy mind, anchored in spiritual wisdom and silence, becomes the foundation of a healthy body. So, let us strive not just for fitness, but for inner well-being, where the mind is calm, the soul is strong and the body follows. Because, in the end, lasting health is not just about how we live, but also about how we think, feel and connect with the Source.

The writer is a spiritual teacher and popular columnist

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Tamil Nadu's costly power purchase

The Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Limited's (TNPDCL) decision to purchase short-term emergency power from private entities at over ₹30 per unit is deeply concerning. It places an additional burden on public funds and raises questions about the ruling TVK government's planning. Neighbouring Andhra Pradesh reportedly secured power for October 2026 through advance tendering at ₹16-₹20 per unit, while Tamil Nadu waited until the last moment. Equally worrying is the state's power generation. Against a conventional thermal capacity of over 5,000 MW, actual production reportedly struggled to reach 3,000 MW. Why are Tamil Nadu's power plants operating below capacity when demand is high?

The government cannot dismiss these expensive purchases as a temporary measure to prevent load shedding. The alleged additional expenditure of₹5 crore a day points to the need for better forecasting, timely procurement and improved plant performance.

A state cannot progress sustainably without efficient planning and accountable administration. Can Tamil Nadu move beyond personality-driven politics towards an institutionalised system of governance that prioritises public welfare, financial prudence and reliable electricity supply?

RANGANATHAN SIVAKUMAR | CHENNAI

Reservation through separate institutions

If reservations are to be extended on the grounds that a large majority of India's population belongs to BC, OBC, SC and ST communities, an alternative approach could be to establish exclusive institutions and administrative structures managed by members of these communities.

Separate educational institutions, government departments, hospitals, banks, police stations, courts and polling arrangements could be staffed entirely by members of reserved categories. Similarly, representation in legislative assemblies, Parliament and ministerial positions could reflect the proportion of these communities in the population. Such segregation could ensure proportional representation while reducing friction arising from competition and allegations of discrimination, bias and social harassment in educational institutions, workplaces and public offices. It could also create environments where disadvantaged communities feel secure, represented and empowered. Leadership positions, promotions and decision-making could become more accessible to underrepresented groups, promoting social mobility, confidence and community-specific solutions. Such an approach could strengthen dignity, representation and self-governance, though its impact on social integration requires consideration.

O PRASADA RAO | HYDERABAD

Kalam's vision of an inclusive India

As India observes the 95th birth anniversary of APJ Abdul Kalam on 15 October, his life offers an opportunity to examine whether the country is advancing towards the inclusive, knowledge-driven society he envisioned.

Rising from modest beginnings in Rameswaram to the highest constitutional office, Kalam demonstrated the transformative power of education and perseverance. His contributions to ISRO and DRDO, including the SLV-III project, missile development and Pokhran-II tests, strengthened India's technological and defence capabilities. Yet, as the People's President (2002-2007) and a lifelong teacher, his legacy rests equally on his accessibility and faith in youth.

Kalam's *India 2020* vision emphasised technological progress, rural development and self-reliance. Despite advances in digital technology and space exploration, unemployment, educational inequality and the digital divide remain challenges. His principles of scientific temper, ethical responsibility and independent thinking offer guidance in the age of AI. Strengthening public education, scientific research and inclusive growth would be a fitting tribute to his vision.

AC VINEETH KUMAR | KERALA

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | THURSDAY | OCTOBER 15, 2026

Bihar floods: The need for a continuous record

Bihar's recurring floods demand more than daily casualty and damage figures. A consistent reporting system linking flood phases, affected communities, river conditions and relief operations can track cumulative impacts, improve coordination, strengthen accountability and support long-term recovery



EKLAVYA PRASAD

Floods in Bihar rarely occur as isolated events. They arrive in successive phases, affect different parts of the state and sometimes return to places already hit. A family may still be recovering from lost crops, damaged housing or depleted savings when another flood arrives. Flood reporting must therefore do more than count those affected by the latest rise in water levels. It must show where flooding occurs, how often it returns and how its effects accumulate over the monsoon season.



Bihar already has a flood-reporting mechanism. The Disaster Management Department (DMD), Government of Bihar, publishes daily flood reports and press releases. The challenge is to make these instruments more consistent, connect the information they provide and maintain a reliable record of the flood season.

The first step is to make the reporting system easier to follow. The daily report appears under different titles, including Flood/Heavy Rainfall Report, Daily Flood Report and Daily Flood Situation Report. The department should adopt one consistent title, such as *Daily Flood Situation Report*, so affected communities, disaster-response agencies, development partners and government officials can readily identify the same reporting series across dates. Press releases also appear under different titles, including Hindi titles. Their titles need not match that of the daily report, but each release should clearly identify its purpose and the flood phase it covers.

The September 2 daily report summarised affected areas and relief operations, while the accompanying press release detailed specific incidents, river conditions and administrative responses, including erosion in Bhagalpur and flooding in Bhojpur. The September 15 documents similarly demonstrate how the formats can complement each other. Both recorded 15 affected districts and 575 gram panchayats. The daily report provided a summary, while the press release included additional information on relief operations and river conditions. Linking these records would help affected communities, disaster-response agencies, development partners and government officials understand both the scale of the situation and the response under way.

The Daily Flood Report should consistently distinguish three measures: changes during the preceding 24 hours, impacts recorded during each flood phase and cumulative impacts across the season. These figures should be clearly labelled and kept separate. Phase-specific press releases can provide focused updates on important developments, while the daily report maintains the continuing record.

The need for this distinction becomes clear when the September and October reports are read together. The September 24 Daily Flood Report recorded cumulative impacts across 15 districts, 576 gram panchayats and 50.49 lakh people, before the third flood phase developed around September 28-29. By October 7, the Daily Flood Report recorded 22 affected districts and 61.72 lakh people affected cumulatively during the monsoon season. The October 4 press release, focusing specifically on the third phase along and around the Gandak, reported approximately 9.87 lakh people affected across six districts, 30 blocks and 169 gram panchayats. By October 11, the press release for the same phase reported approximately 10.22 lakh people affected across six districts, 33 blocks and 173 gram panchayats. These figures describe the evolving impact of the third phase, while the daily report records cumulative seasonal impacts. They should therefore be linked to provide a clearer picture of how each flood phase contributes to the wider seasonal impact, rather than added together as separate totals.

The reporting system should connect such phase-specific accounts to the seasonal record. It should show which places were affected in each phase, which remained inundated and which experienced flooding again. This also raises an important question about affected populations. If the same community is flooded more than once, how can seasonal figures avoid counting the same people repeatedly while still recording repeated exposure? The total number of people affected and the number exposed to multiple floods measure different aspects of the disaster. Reporting should make that distinction clear.

The same clarity is needed for relief operations. Reports should distinguish assistance provided during a particular phase from assistance provided earlier and from the seasonal total. They should state how many community kitchens are operating on a given day, distinguish this from the total established over time and specify the period covered by meal figures. Without these distinctions, affected communities, disaster-response agencies, development partners and government officials cannot reliably interpret what the numbers represent. The Daily Flood Report also needs to identify affected blocks and gram panchayats by name under each district, rather than provide only aggregate figures. This would help affected communities, disaster-response agencies, development partners and officials identify where flooding has occurred, which areas remain affected and where flooding has returned. The same location-wise information should be updated and carried forward in subsequent reports to build a clear record of changing conditions.

River conditions need equally clear reporting. Reports should identify the rivers being observed, show water levels against warning and danger levels, and indicate whether levels are rising or falling. They should also record how long places remain inundated. A falling river level does not necessarily mean that a village is accessible or that drinking water, health care and other essential services have resumed.

Reporting should distinguish between different kinds of damage. A road under water is different from one washed away. A hand pump or piped water supply system that cannot be reached is different from one that has been damaged. A school temporarily cut off is different from one with structural damage. Reports should distinguish assets that are inundated, inaccessible, non-functional, damaged or destroyed. Over time, they should also capture verified impacts on drinking water, sanitation, health care, transport, schools, crops, livestock, housing and livelihoods.

Consistency across reporting days is equally important. Each report should state its cut-off time and indicate whether figures are provisional, verified or revised. Significant changes should be explained, and earlier reports should remain available in a searchable archive. This would allow communities, researchers, development workers, journalists and officials to follow the situation without piecing together information from scattered documents.

These improvements need not require an entirely new data collection system. Much of the information is already generated by departments and district administrations. What is needed is a clear process for collating, verifying and presenting it consistently. The Daily Flood Report should be published regularly, including when the situation stabilises, so that the seasonal record remains continuous.

The need for greater continuity is evident in the online reporting record. As observed on October 13, the latest daily report available was dated October 7, while press releases were available through October 11. The priority should be to maintain a regular, up-to-date Daily Flood Report alongside timely press releases. Together, they can provide both a continuous account of the flood situation and focused updates on significant developments.

The value of this approach extends beyond immediate relief. A continuous record can help assess losses, plan recovery and identify settlements repeatedly inundated, infrastructure that fails more than once and communities whose recovery is interrupted by successive floods.

Bihar does not need figures merely for the sake of having more figures. It needs a connected account of what changed, where it changed, what remained unresolved and how impacts accumulated across successive flood phases. Strengthening the existing Daily Flood Report and linking it more effectively with press releases would make flood information easier to understand and more useful for relief coordination, public accountability and future planning.

THE SEPTEMBER 24 DAILY FLOOD REPORT RECORDED CUMULATIVE IMPACTS ACROSS 15 DISTRICTS, 576 GRAM PANCHAYATS AND 50.49 LAKH PEOPLE, BEFORE THE THIRD FLOOD PHASE DEVELOPED AROUND SEPTEMBER 28-29. BY OCTOBER 7, THE DAILY FLOOD REPORT RECORDED 22 AFFECTED DISTRICTS AND 61.72 LAKH PEOPLE AFFECTED CUMULATIVELY DURING THE MONSOON SEASON. THE OCTOBER 4 PRESS RELEASE, FOCUSING SPECIFICALLY ON THE THIRD PHASE ALONG AND AROUND THE GANDAK, REPORTED APPROXIMATELY 9.87 LAKH PEOPLE AFFECTED ACROSS SIX DISTRICTS, 30 BLOCKS AND 169 GRAM PANCHAYATS

The writer is the Managing Trustee of Megh Pyne Abhiyan

Politics of protest: The Opposition's dangerous drift



TUHIN A SINHA

India is witnessing an unsettling contest in which political opposition increasingly risks being reduced to a competition in disruption. The Congress and the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) appear to be converging on a common strategy of street mobilisation, confrontation with constitutional institutions and relentless amplification of allegations. The question is no longer merely whether the Opposition can challenge the government, but whether it is willing to respect the democratic processes through which governments are elected and disputes are resolved.

The BJP's recent by-election victories in Assam and West Bengal, including in minority-dominated constituencies, have challenged entrenched political assumptions. These results reaffirm that voters cannot be taken for granted. Faced with a BJP that continues to demonstrate electoral resilience, the Opposition appears increasingly tempted to substitute street spectacle for a persuasive political alternative.

The examples of Nepal and Bangladesh offer a cautionary tale. Rahul Gandhi has previously invoked youth-led upheavals abroad while addressing young Indians. But India is a constitutional democracy with an elected Parliament, an independent judiciary and established mechanisms for peaceful political change. Importing the vocabulary of street-driven regime change into Indian politics risks blurring the distinction between democratic protest and destabilisation. Disruption cannot become a substitute for democratic persuasion.

Consider Rahul Gandhi's reported remarks following his interaction with the President. Expressing surprise that the President had not rebutted his allegations of vote theft after receiving a memorandum betrays a fundamental distinction: receiving a representation is not the same as endorsing its contents. Constitutional office-holders routinely receive memoranda without certifying the claims they contain. The President's courtesy cannot be converted into an implied admission of the Opposition's allegations.

This is not the first controversy involving Rahul Gandhi's interpretation of constitutional institutions. His earlier remarks concerning the Supreme Court's Rafale proceedings led to an apology. Political leaders have a responsibility to distinguish between allegations, demonstrable facts and what constitutional authorities have actually said. Repeating an accusation does not make it true. The present protests raise another troubling question: why escalate street mobilisation when the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls is already under the Supreme Court's scrutiny? If the Opposition possesses compelling evidence of electoral wrongdoing, it should present it before the Court. If the Election Commission's explanations are inadequate, the shortcomings must be demonstrated. The judicial process must be allowed to run its course.



By seeking to amplify political pressure while proceedings are under way, the Opposition risks creating the impression that it is more interested in shaping the public narrative than awaiting judicial findings. A courtroom is where evidence is tested; the street cannot become an alternative route to a judicial outcome. Constitutional institutions must be permitted to function without being overshadowed by political brinkmanship.

The Modi government was justified in taking firm action to prevent demonstrations from degenerating into a law-and-order crisis in the national capital. Governance requires prevention, not merely a response after disorder erupts. When protesters threaten to breach barricades, obstruct essential routes or disrupt public institutions, the administration cannot remain a passive spectator.

Delhi is not an open-air political theatre available for indefinite occupation by any party seeking confrontation. It is the capital of the Republic, where hospitals, courts, schools, offices, transport networks and diplomatic missions must continue to function. Millions of ordinary citizens cannot be made collateral damage in a partisan political contest. The police have a duty to maintain public order, enforce lawful restrictions and prevent foreseeable escalation. The claim that every firm police response constitutes an assault on democracy distorts the relationship between liberty and responsibility. The right to protest is not a licence to paralyse public life, disregard lawful orders or compel constitutional institutions to submit to street pressure. Peaceful democratic engagement is welcome; disorder and unlawful obstruction must invite firm, lawful action.

Social media has made this challenge more acute. Viral videos, slogans and short-form content can create an impression of certainty long before evidence is examined. From the Citizenship Amendment Act to reservation policies and now electoral-roll revision, complex issues have repeatedly been reduced to inflammatory narratives. Young Indians deserve facts and context, not to be mobilised through misinformation for the political ambitions of others.

The costs of perpetual agitation extend beyond law and order. India is investing in infrastructure, manufacturing, energy security and technological competitiveness. Where is the Opposition's credible roadmap for employment, economic growth and preparing young Indians for an economy transformed by artificial intelligence? When every institutional disagreement becomes a conspiracy and every administrative action is portrayed as repression, substantive debate is crowded out by manufactured outrage.

Public patience, too, has limits. Citizens have jobs to reach, schools to attend, businesses to run and families to care for. Public spaces belong to everyone, not exclusively to professional political protesters. When agitation becomes an end in itself, it ceases to serve the public and begins imposing costs upon it.

India needs an Opposition that scrutinises the government, exposes wrongdoing and offers credible alternatives. But criticism must be backed by evidence, allegations must be established and political mobilisation must remain within the boundaries of democratic responsibility. No party can claim a monopoly over democracy or demand that constitutional rules be suspended whenever they become inconvenient.

India stands at a decisive inflection point. The Viksit Bharat mission requires institutional confidence, sustained economic momentum and a national focus on the opportunities ahead. The country cannot afford to have its aspirations derailed by a politics of perpetual confrontation. The choice before India is between democratic competition that strengthens institutions and a politics that risks weakening them through relentless disruption. A confident democracy accommodates dissent while enforcing the law. It does not confuse anarchy with accountability. Viksit Bharat cannot be built by paralysing the present. It must be built by debating the future and refusing to let the politics of anarchy derail the aspirations of a nation.

The writer is a national spokesperson of BJP and acclaimed author

Bastar's transformation and the role of Prime Minister Modi's resolve



NANDAN JAIN

There are certain figures in public life whose identities are shaped not merely by the offices they hold or the political victories they secure, but by their connection with the people and their determination to transform the course of the nation. Prime Minister Narendra Modi is one such leader. From his tenure as Chief Minister of Gujarat to his stewardship of the country as Prime Minister, the past 25 years of his public life represent a journey marked by political experience, sustained engagement and an abiding commitment to public service.

Prime Minister Modi's political journey cannot be assessed solely through electoral victories or the number of government schemes launched during his tenure. One of the defining features of his leadership has been his ability to establish a direct connect with the people. Bringing the aspirations of citizens from diverse regions into the larger discourse on national development has remained an important element of his political approach.

Today, Modi occupies a central place in Indian politics, with large sections of the population looking to him for stable leadership, decisive action and the fulfilment of the country's national aspirations. This public confidence is, in itself, a considerable political asset. Yet, sustaining that confidence requires continuous engagement, accountability and tangible results on the ground. Initiatives such as the Seva Sankalp campaign provide an opportunity for the organisation to deepen its engagement with the people and reaffirm its commitment to their welfare.

Among the many significant aspects of Prime Minister Modi's tenure, the sustained effort to eliminate Naxalite violence stands out as particularly consequential. His firm resolve has contributed to a decisive shift in regions that were once afflicted by Left-Wing Extremism. Areas where violence had taken root amid the absence of adequate educational opportunities and basic amenities are now witnessing a gradual transition towards development. Bastar has emerged as a compelling example of this transformation. Inspired by the Prime Minister's vision and supported by sustained efforts to restore peace and expand development, the region is seeking to leave behind the shadow of Maoist violence and embark on a new journey of progress.

As Prime Minister Narendra Modi completes 25 years in public life, the Seva Sankalp campaign being undertaken in Chhattisgarh seeks to take the message of development to villages and connect people with the larger national resolve for progress. As part of this initiative, I had the opportunity to interact with schoolchildren in Tarandul village of Kanker district, in the Bastar division. Our conversation centred on their aspirations, interests and future career opportunities. Spending time with the children, understanding their dreams and encouraging them to pursue education was an enriching and deeply personal experience. Schoolbags and books were distributed among them, along with a message that education remains one of the most enduring means of achieving their goals.



The interaction offered a glimpse into the aspirations of children in rural and remote areas. Even in villages far removed from major urban centres, young minds are looking towards a future shaped by progress, opportunity and achievement. For many of them, Prime Minister Modi's life and journey serve as a source of inspiration. His rise from a modest family background to the highest executive office in the country conveys a powerful message: that perseverance, determination and sustained effort can help turn ambitious dreams into reality. Such examples can encourage children to nurture their aspirations and equip themselves to pursue them with confidence.

This, indeed, is the spirit of the Seva Sankalp campaign: to reach out to people, understand their aspirations and strengthen the bond with them through service. Realising the vision of a Viksit Bharat under Prime Minister Modi's leadership requires sustained efforts to extend access to education, skills, healthcare and employment opportunities to the remotest parts of the country. The time spent with children in Tarandul served as a reminder of a larger national responsibility: investing in the opportunities available to children today is essential to building a stronger India tomorrow.

In a state such as Chhattisgarh, endowed with abundant natural resources and a distinctive tribal cultural heritage, development must be understood in terms that go well beyond the construction of roads, buildings and other physical infrastructure. It must also mean ensuring better educational and healthcare facilities in remote villages, creating opportunities for young people, enabling women to become economically self-reliant and integrating rural households into the mainstream of development. Only when the benefits of progress reach the last mile can development acquire a truly inclusive character.

As Chhattisgarh looks towards the Assembly elections in 2028 and the Lok Sabha elections in 2029, sustained organisational engagement will remain important. However, our preparations must extend beyond electoral calculations. The long-term strength of any political organisation rests on its ability to earn public trust, communicate the benefits of government programmes, understand the challenges encountered in their implementation and maintain an enduring dialogue with different sections of society.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi's public journey offers an important lesson in this regard: progress demands the will to keep moving forward, but lasting public confidence can be secured only by remaining connected with the people. The transformation unfolding in Bastar must therefore be viewed not merely as a change in the region's circumstances, but as an opportunity to build a future in which peace, education, opportunity and inclusive development become the foundations of lasting progress.

The writer is the State Vice-President of the Bharatiya Janata Party, Chhattisgarh

Houthis attack Saudi Aramco HQ, say officials

SAMY MAGDY/CARA ANNA ■ Cairo



Two regional officials say offices belonging to senior executives with Saudi oil giant Aramco were hit in an overnight Houthi strike on the company's headquarters (HQ), in the latest demonstration of the Iran-backed rebels' ability to attack high-profile targets even after issuing warnings that they would do so.

The officials said the top three floors in a building used by top executives were damaged. One official said the office of the company's chief executive was among those hit. There were no casualties. The officials spoke on condition of anonymity because they were not authorised to discuss the matter with the media.

The Houthis earlier said they targeted Dhahran, which hosts the headquarters, with a ballistic missile. Earlier on Wednesday, new explosions were heard in the Saudi capital, residents said, as blame again quickly fell on Iran-backed Houthi rebels in neighbouring Yemen. A Houthi official said that powers including Russia and China had reached out to the rebels in search of a ceasefire deal.

The sight of smoke rising from some of Saudi Arabia's most sensitive facilities in recent days has rattled the region and global markets while increasing questions for President Donald Trump, who has said he is evaluating whether the US should join Saudi strikes against the Houthis.

In the latest attacks, the Saudi-led military coalition fighting the Houthis said it intercepted a ballistic missile targeting Dhahran; cruise and ballistic missiles and drones targeting the capital, Riyadh; and a cruise missile targeting Al-Kharj, home to Prince Sultan Air Base and the State-owned Military Industries Corporation.

The Houthis called the latest attacks retaliation for "treacherous Saudi aggression" against the rebel-held Yemeni capital of Sanaa and other areas.

Separately, the rebel-run Health Ministry reported two dead in attacks in Yemen on Tuesday and blamed the Saudis. The Houthis have repeatedly targeted Saudi airports, military facilities and oil infrastructure in the latest front in the Iran war. One of the Riyadh residents, who spoke on condition of anonymity for their safety, lives in northern Riyadh, where King Khalid International Airport — targeted multiple times in the past week with strikes that have killed at least 18 people and hurt over 300 more — is located.

The Houthis, hardened by years of civil war, have emerged as Iran's most effective armed proxy of the moment, but experts say they also have their own agenda. Either way, they are applying increasing pressure on a key US ally.

A senior Houthi official told *The Associated Press* that regional and international powers have reached out in an effort to stop the attacks on Saudi Arabia as part of a ceasefire deal. (*AP*)

Malaysian court rejects former PM Najib Razak's appeal



ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Kuala Lumpur

Former Malaysian Prime Minister Najib Razak on Wednesday lost a bid to delay the enforcement of a 15-year jail sentence for corruption.

Najib, 73, has been imprisoned since August 2022 in a corruption case linked to the multibillion-dollar looting of the 1MDB state investment fund that outraged the nation and caused the downfall of his long-ruling party.

Last year he was convicted and sentenced to another 15 years and fined 11.4 billion ringgit (USD 2.8 billion) in a second, bigger graft trial tied to the 1MDB fund. He was found guilty of abuse of power and money laundering related to over $700 million channelled into his bank accounts from the fund. That sentence was due to take effect after he completes his current sentence in August 2028. The High Court on Wednesday dismissed his application to postpone the enforcement of his second sentence, saying there was no merit. Najib's lawyer Muhammad Shafee Abdullah said they would challenge the decision in a higher court. Najib set up the 1MDB development fund shortly after taking office in 2009. (*AP*)

Russia still hitting energy sites, says Zelenskyy

HANNA ARHIROVA/ SAMYA KULLAB ■ Kyiv



Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy voiced outrage on Wednesday over Russia's continuing aerial bombardment of Ukraine's energy infrastructure in apparent defiance of US President Donald Trump's demand for a ceasefire.

Moscow's forces pounded Ukraine's power grid, as well as oil and gas facilities, for the third straight night, Zelenskyy said, after Trump claimed that Russia and Ukraine had agreed to an "energy ceasefire" 4.5 years after Moscow's forces invaded. Zelenskyy, meanwhile, has agreed to halt Ukraine's monthslong campaign targeting Russian oil refineries that caused fuel shortages for Russians. Ukraine's last reported hit on an oil refinery was last Friday.

The Kremlin has not confirmed that Moscow signed off on the truce, with a spokesman saying only that "contacts on this matter continue." Trump's efforts to stop the fighting have made no progress. Ukrainian officials say they are pushing back Russian forces in eastern Ukraine, which Russia's bigger army has been trying to capture for years.

Ukraine has liberated 277 square kilometers in the operation that started in the summer, Ukraine's Third Army Corps commander Brigadier General Andrii Biletskyi said on Wednesday.

It was not possible to independently verify the claim, and Russian officials did not comment.

Ukrainian officials fear US support for the war effort is falling away after Trump struck a deal with Russian President Vladimir Putin to import Russian diesel despite international efforts to sanction Russia for its invasion and isolate Putin.

Ukrainian officials said the deal would help Russia continue its invasion, while European leaders fear Moscow's wider ambitions on the continent and accuse Russia of sabotage as part of a hybrid war on the continent. (*AP*)

Death sentence overturned for Sri Lankan worker

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Colombo



Anojan Sivarasa

Saudi Arabia's Supreme Court has overturned the death sentence imposed on a Sri Lankan migrant worker over a comment he made on Facebook, Sri Lanka's deputy foreign minister said on Wednesday.

Anojan Sivarasa, 27, was sentenced to death in September after being convicted of blasphemy against Islam and the Prophet Muhammad over his comment. Sri Lanka's Deputy Foreign Minister Arun Hemachandra confirmed in a Facebook post that the verdict had been overturned.

Hemachandra said, in a "major relief", the Supreme Court of Saudi Arabia on Tuesday set aside the death sentence imposed on Sivarasa.

He said this verdict was due to sustained diplomatic and legal efforts by the Government of Sri Lanka.

UK diaspora groups protest in solidaritywith Delhi



ADITI KHANNA ■ London

A section of diaspora groups in the UK organised an "Emergency Protest" outside the High Commission of India in London in solidarity with the protests in New Delhi.

Convened by the South Asia Solidarity Group, Cambridge South Asian Forum Against Hindutva, Indian Workers' Association and SOAS Ambedkar Society, among other groups, the protest on Tuesday evening attracted a large student gathering, with participants expressing solidarity with the "Jantar Mantar 2.0 protests" and the struggle in India to defend the right to vote and the right to protest. The gathering was called to "amplify" the demands of the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP), including the demand for the removal of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar and the scrapping of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in India.

"This is not just about one corrupt official, it is a mass uprising," said Mukti Shah of the South Asia Solidarity Group. "For us in Britain, it is especially important because this regime is a key player in the global far-right, which is increasingly active in this country." Student group leaders addressed the gathering, calling on members to organise in solidarity with the protesters in India. (*PTI*)

Bulgarian Government suspects Russia in Black Sea drone strikes

ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Sofia



Bulgaria on Wednesday said Russia was likely behind drone attacks that struck four ships in the Black Sea in the past week, sinking two, but there was no way of proving Moscow's culpability.

Rescuers are still searching for 11 crew members missing after drone strikes on Tuesday sank two ships in Bulgaria's exclusive economic zone and adjacent waters, while five other crew members were rescued.

One of the ships is registered to Guinea-Bissau but the other one, the Chelsea-3, is Ukrainian-owned, registered in Odesa and sails under the flag of Malta, a European Union member. "There is no logic in Ukraine attacking its own ships and crews, given that the outcome of all these attacks favours Russia - and indeed, the logic points in that direction. The problem is that we cannot prove it," Bulgarian Prime Minister Rumen Radev told Parliament. Radev on Tuesday summoned the Russian ambassador to Sofia, who said she does not have any information from the Russian defence ministry but she did not rule out the possibility that "these attacks represent a provocation by a third party."

The Guinea-Bissau-flagged cargo ship Dignity sank Tuesday after it was hit by a military strike. Four sailors, three Syrian nationals and one Egyptian, were rescued and arrived in the port of Varna, district Gov. Mario Smarkov said. "All four appeared to be in relatively good condition and had sustained no injuries," he said. A fifth sailor is expected to arrive later on Wednesday. Smarkov said the search for the 11 missing crew members continues.

Bulgaria has requested international assistance for the investigation into attacks on commercial vessels, as well as NATO support to strengthen surveillance and control systems and response capabilities against drone attacks.

President Iliana Yotova called for an immediate halt to hostilities in the Black Sea and a moratorium on drone attacks against commercial and civilian infrastructure, following the latest drone attacks.

"The unprecedented attacks demonstrate that the war has reached the Black Sea and that the conflict is intensifying," Yotova said in an TV interview on Tuesday.

She explained that coordinated steps have been taken with her colleagues from Romania and Turkiye in the wake of the growing risks and dangers in the Black Sea basin.

"The aim is a moratorium on the use of drones over the Black Sea against commercial and civilian infrastructure and to halt hostilities over the sea," Yotova said.

Delayed China–North Korea bridge prepares to open

ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Beijing



A new bridge linking China and North Korea is set to open on Thursday after more than a decade of delay in the latest sign of closer ties between the two countries. The official Chinese news agency *Xinhua* reported Wednesday that both sides will hold a ceremony for the launch of the New Yalu River Bridge. The four-lane, 3-kilometre (1.8-mile) bridge will connect the northeastern Chinese city of Dandong to the North Korean city of Sinuiju.

The bridge initially was expected to enter use in 2014 after China apparently completed construction of access roads, customs facilities and other related infrastructure on its side. But the date passed with no sign of an opening and without North Korea doing corresponding works on its side. At that time, it prompted an unusually sharp report in the Global Times, a newspaper affiliated with the Chinese Communist Party, which quoted Dandong residents expressing frustration over delays in what they had hoped would be an economic boon for their border city.

A lack of substantial work on the North Korean side prompted speculation that North Korea was wary of an increase in economic dependence or was unhappy with China voting for United Nations resolutions toughening international sanctions on the North over its nuclear program. Some observers said North Korea and China also differed over the location of the bridge. A Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson said on Wednesday the new bridge will further promote economic, trade and "people-to-people exchanges."

"China and the DPRK are friendly neighbours linked by rivers and mountains," said Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson Mao Ning. She added the bridge is an important "project for connectivity" between the two countries.

The new link is expected to lessen the burden on an existing yet aging bridge on the Dandong-Sinuiju route, which handles more than 70 per cent of official trade between the two countries. The old bridge built in 1937 carries a railway line as well as cars and trucks, but vehicle traffic can move only one way at a time.

Ship sank after striking mine in Hormuz: Iran

ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Dubai



A boat floats as commercial vessels appear anchored in the Strait of Hormuz off Bandar Abbas, Iran AP

A cargo ship has sunk after hitting a naval mine in the Strait of Hormuz, Iran's Revolutionary Guard Corps navy said.

It was the first time Iran has reported a ship sinking after hitting a mine during the war. There were few details, including about the fate of the crew. State TV quoted a Guard statement saying the ship was travelling on what it called an illegal and dangerous route when it hit the mine on Wednesday morning.

It said the ship was carrying 2,500 containers when it first caught fire. Iran has repeatedly warned ships against trying to transit the strait without its approval.

The US military has been guiding ships through the strait on a route off Oman on the far side. There was no immediate verification of the sinking and no report by the United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations monitor.

Iran on Wednesday hanged a man accused of an "armed operation" against the theocracy in support of exiled former Crown Prince Reza Pahlavi. A report by Mizan, an outlet affiliated with the Islamic Republic's judiciary, identified the man as Ali Sina Mostafavi and said he opened fire earlier during the Iran war and injured several people including a child in the southeastern city of Kerman. Executions of people on similar charges have prompted an international outcry. UN experts this month called on Iran to halt all executions.

UK study visa refusals impact university offers for foreign students: Report

ADITI KHANNA ■ London



International students, including Indians, are likely to be impacted as British universities revoke offers to courses amid a clampdown on study visas issued by the UK Home Office, according to a media analysis this week.

The *Financial Times* newspaper analysed official data to find that universities are taking the step to withdraw offers to students over fears of facing a blanket ban on their ability to recruit foreign students. Under the Home Office rules, education institutions where more than 5 per cent of prospective international students given offers subsequently have their visa applications rejected face the risk of being banned from recruiting them.

This tightening of the previous 10 per cent threshold is aimed at what the UK Government believes is the abuse of the student visa route by certain nationalities, led by Pakistanis and Nigerians.

"Many refusals appear to rest on flawed, inconsistent and highly subjective reasoning, forcing universities to withdraw offers at scale to avoid breaching compliance thresholds," said Jamie Arrowsmith, director of Universities UK International (UUKi) — which represents institutions recruiting abroad. While acknowledging the need to maintain confidence in the immigration system, he stressed that "visa processing has become markedly less predictable".

The Financial Times said its analysis of Home Office data showed that in the first half of this year, 10.5 per cent of study visa applications to the UK ended up being withdrawn, up from 2.3 per cent in the same period last year .

Around 40.9 per cent of prospective students from Pakistan had visa applications withdrawn in the first six months of this year, up from 3 per cent in the same period last year. Further down the list was 22.7 per cent of study visa applications from Nigeria being withdrawn in the first half of this year, up from 4.5 per cent in the first half of 2025.

Sir David Bell, vice-chancellor of the University of Sunderland, told the newspaper: "The recent and unexpected spike in visa refusals has prompted pre-emptive action in several universities.

"This has involved pulling back from international markets where a tougher approach is being taken to visa applications." The newspaper also referenced figures in the higher education sector to flag that around 15 universities are thought to have suspended recruitment from Pakistan entirely this year.

Professor Steven McGuire, deputy vice-chancellor of the University of East Anglia, said the policy's effect may be that UK universities "double down" on China and India where refusal rates are lower.

The Home Office said that while international students "make a positive contribution" to Britain, "this must not be at the expense of recruiting responsibly, in turn protecting the integrity of our immigration system", offering universities "support where needed to improve recruitment practices". (*PTI*)

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | THURSDAY | OCTOBER 15, 2026

Monetary rules are not enough, when inflation is fiscal: 2026 Economics Nobel



LEKHA CHAKRABORTY

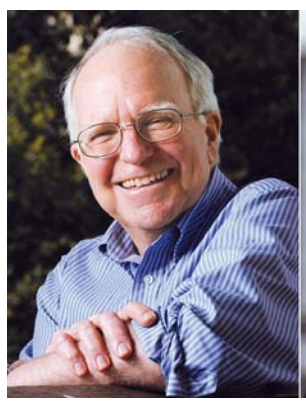
This year's Nobel Prize in Economic Sciences went to two quiet revolutionaries — Robert E Hall of Stanford and Michael Woodford of Columbia.

Their citation —"for micro-economic foundations of macroeconomic stabilisation" — sounds technical. In reality, they rewired how the world thinks about stopping economic crises before they spiral.

After the 1970s oil shocks left inflation and unemployment rising simultaneously, the old rulebooks collapsed. Central banks had been playing a simple game — raise rates when prices climbed, cut them when jobs vanished. That game stopped working. Hall and Woodford didn't patch the old models. They rebuilt them from the ground up starting with how real households and firms actually decide what to do.

Hall's breakthrough came in 1978. Building on Milton Friedman's permanent income idea, he showed that most people don't spend every extra rupee or dollar the moment it arrives. They look ahead. They smooth consumption across their lifetimes. Only genuine news about future income moves the needle. The data largely confirmed it (except for a crucial minority of "hand-to-mouth" households living paycheck to paycheck). That distinction still shapes how we judge economic stimulus packages, tax cuts, and automatic stabilisers today.

Woodford took the next leap. His 2003 masterpiece, "Interest and Prices", became the operating manual for modern central banks. Because prices are sticky and people look forward, words matter as much as rate decisions. Forward guidance — clear signals about where interest rates are headed- emerged as a powerful tool. It proved indispensable after 2008 and again during the pandemic,



Robert E Hall



Michael Woodford

when rates hit zero and conventional firepower ran out.

He also explained why the Taylor rule works, which is the basis of inflation targeting — the central bank must raise interest rates more than one-for-one with inflation, while also reacting to economic slack. Anything less, and self fulfilling expectations can send inflation spinning out of control. Today, policymakers everywhere speak the language Hall and Woodford taught them — natural rates of interest, output gaps, credibility of forecasts. Four decades ago that vocabulary would have sounded like science fiction.

Yet Woodford's own work contains a sharp warning that too many still ignore. In his "Fiscal theories of Price Determination," he demonstrated that even the best monetary rule is not enough. Price stability also demands a coherent fiscal rule. Inflation is not purely a monetary phenomenon. When it is fiscal in origin, monetary policy alone cannot pin it down.

The logic is straightforward and unforgiving. An independent central bank can control interest rates and shape expectations. But if the fiscal authority runs fiscal deficits that are inconsistent with the desired price path, those efforts can be overwhelmed. The two arms of policy are linked through the government's intertemporal budget constraint. Stabilisation is a joint product, or it fails.

Woodford's insight revives the older "unpleasant monetarist arithmetic" of Sargent and Wallace. Bond financing of deficits works only while the real interest rate stays below the economy's growth rate. When r exceeds g, the fiscal deficit eventually has to be monetised. Seigniorage returns, and inflation follows. Post-pandemic, many Governments played with exactly this path. Woodford stopped short of endorsing Modern Monetary Theory, but he left no doubt that fiscal discipline is not optional if you want stable prices.

Hall, for his part, spent years chairing the NBER's Business Cycle Dating Committee, giving the profession a careful, multi-indicator map of peaks and troughs. A significant work by Gita Gopinath and others challenges the neatness of that map for emerging economies, where downturns can leave "permanent scars" rather than temporary cyclical dips. The framework still matters, the context has grown more complicated.

The Nobel laureates did not simply give us better forecasting models. They showed us that monetary rules, no matter how sophisticated, cannot carry the full burden of price stability when fiscal policy is on a collision course with them.

The institutions that manage money and the institutions that manage budgets must move in concert- or the inflation we thought we had tamed will return by another fiscalist door. 2026 Economics Nobel reiterated the significance of fiscal rules to prelude monetary rules. Who gets to write the rules and how they use the rules determine the economic growth, because the macroeconomic path we take is equally important as destination to curb deficits.

The writer is professor at NIPFP, Ministry of Finance, Govt of India and also research affiliate at the Levy Economics Institute of Bard College, New York

7th Amity Model United Nations commences



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Amity Educational Resource Centre – the Global Gateway of the Amity Group of Schools, is organising the 17th Chapter of the Amity International Model United Nations (AIMUN 2026), from October 14-16, at Amity University Noida, on the theme "Youth Leadership is the Future of the World".

Around 500 participants from India and across the world, including France, the Philippines, UAE, China, UK, South Korea, Poland, Slovenia Japan, Russia and China Russia, have participated in AIMUN 2026.

Inaugurating AIMUN 2026, Chief Guest Jean-Eric Paquet, Ambassador-designate of the European Union to India, emphasised the importance of international cooperation in addressing global challenges, stating, "India, Europe and the United Nations are working together to find solutions to the challenges facing the world.

Dr Amita Chauhan, Chairperson, Amity Group of Schools, said, "AIMUN provides a valuable platform for students to nurture their abilities, showcase their talent and develop the skills required to become future leaders. Students must aspire to achieve great things and work diligently towards their goals. "Guest of Honour Oh Jin-hee, Deputy Chief of Mission, Embassy of the Republic of Korea, highlighted the need for global collaboration in addressing contemporary challenges

A special highlight of AIMUN 2026 was the presentation of the Young Noble Peace Prize 2026 to Daniel Obst, President and CEO of AFS Intercultural Programs, USA.

ED seizes ₹2,033 crore assets of Reliance Power under FEMA

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH ■ New Delhi

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has seized assets worth ₹2,032.81 crore from Reliance Power Limited (RPL) under Section 37A of the Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA), 1999. The ED's Headquarters Investigation Unit announced this on 14 October 2026, targeting RPL's bank balances and its shares in Sasan Power Limited. These assets match the value of foreign exchange reportedly held outside India in violation of Section 4 of FEMA.

The investigation began after the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) shared information. SEBI had flagged write-offs and provisions totalling ₹2,101.46 crore in RPL's accounts. These write-offs were linked to overseas investments and loans given to companies in the British Virgin Islands (BVI) and the Cayman Islands.

Searches under FEMA from 6 to 8 March 2026 produced evidence and statements from several people. The investigation found that Reliance Natural Resources Limited (now merged with RPL) raised $300 million through Foreign Currency Convertible Bonds in 2006. Of this, $275 million was invested in its Singapore subsidiary, Reliance Natural Resources (Singapore) Pte Ltd (RNRL-S). RNRL-S deposited the funds with Deutsche Bank (Suisse) SA in Geneva.These deposits were used as collateral for loans given to companies in the British Virgin Islands. The ED says the Reliance Anil Ambani Group managed these BVI companies from India using intermediaries who followed the Group's instructions.

Further investigation showed that the loan money was used for different purposes, including briefly sending funds back to India through companies in Mauritius. In the end, the money benefited the Reliance Anil Ambani Group and was kept outside India. The BVI companies later failed to repay



Deutsche Bank's loans. Documents were fabricated to show that RNRL-S and RPL's Indonesian subsidiaries had made advances to these BVI entities for what appeared to be genuine business purposes.

During the investigation, authorities found that this documentation was backdated and prepared specifically to present the transactions as legitimate commercial dealings. The ED said the seized assets, which include bank balances and shares in Sasan Power Limited, are equal in value to the foreign exchange held abroad in violation of FEMA rules. Section 37A of FEMA allows the ED to seize Indian assets equal to foreign exchange kept outside the country in violation of the law.

This latest action is one of several enforcement steps looking into the Group's cross-border fund movements. Sasan Power Limited, whose shares were seized, runs a large ultra-mega power project in Madhya Pradesh. The market did not react right away because the press release was issued after trading hours on 14 October 2026.

RPL shares were already under pressure because of concerns about the Group's debt and regulatory issues. Analysts note that the seizure is significant compared to the company's recent market value, but the final impact will depend on the investigation and future decisions. The ED's action under Section 37A is meant to secure domestic assets equal to those held abroad while it investigates the alleged FEMA violations. The ED says the investigation is ongoing. So far, no chargesheet or final findings have been shared.

Indian surgeons pioneer maternal fibula grafts to rebuild children's lower limbs

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

Surgeons at Aakash Healthcare Super Speciality Hospital have adapted maternal fibula grafting, previously reported only for the upper limb, to reconstruct lower limbs in children with bone cancer and chronic infection.

Doctors first tried this technique in 2021 to help a 16-year-old girl with severe damage to her right femur from chronic osteomyelitis. Five years later, her mother's bone graft continues to grow, and the girl can walk normally.

The team, led by Dr Aashish Chaudhry, Dr Arun Kumar Giri and Dr Abhishek Kumar Sambharia, found no earlier reports of this method being used for the leg. They decided to try it because amputation was



the only other choice. In 2022, they treated a 14-year-old girl with a long-term femur infection and a poorly healed fracture, and she recovered well. Since then, four more children, three from Uzbekistan and one from Tajikistan, have had the procedure.

In September, doctors removed a cancerous tumour from a five-year-old Uzbek boy's right femur and repaired the bone using his mother's fibula, held in place with a plate. A few days later, an eleven-year-old Uzbek boy with chondroblastic osteosarcoma in his lower femur had the same surgery. Also, in September, a three-year-old boy from Tajikistan finished chemotherapy for Ewing's sarcoma.

Doctors removed the tumour from his right upper arm and rebuilt the bone using his mother's fibula. Earlier in the year, an eleven-year-old Uzbek girl with an infected congenital bone problem in her lower leg had her bone cleared and repaired in stages with a graft. Dr Chaudhary said the child "deserved the chance." He explained that a mother's bone is biologically compatible and offers both support and a meaningful gift. When a child's own bone is not enough, families can benefit from a compatible graft available right away.

Kullu Dussehra held in Delhi



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

International Kullu Dusshehra Curtain Raiser ceremony held at New Delhi. MLA Sundar Singh Thakur said that International Kullu Dussehra is being organised from 21st to 27th October 2026 at Kullu.

He said that Governor Kavinder Gupta will inaugurate the event whereas Chief Minister Thakur Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu will preside over the Closing Ceremony on 27th October. Thakur said that the Global Dance event which will be an amalgamation of local and international dance will be a major attraction besides Drone and Laser show. Principal Resident Commissioner Ajay Yadav, Dy Resident Commissioner Mayank Sharma were also present on the occasion.

RGCIRC forgoes ₹250 cr to treat EWS patients

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Rajiv Gandhi Cancer Institute & Research Centre (RGCIRC) forgoes about ₹250 crore in revenue every year to treat patients from economically weaker sections (EWS), the hospital said .

Dr DS Gangwar, CEO, said cancer affects almost every part of a family's life. Financial aid is important, he said, but patients may also need nutrition, accommodation, counselling. Dr Vineet Talwar, Medical Director at Rohini, said a patient could receive the best clinical care and still struggle with nutrition, accommodation, finances or emotional wellbeing. Dr Gauri Kapoor, Medical Director at Niti Bagh, said families face uncertainty and practical challenges behind every treatment.

MP Manoj Tiwari addresses DU students

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Lok Sabha MP Manoj Tiwari on Wednesday said that students should uphold life values in their conduct and pursue their goals with skill and dedication. Interacting with students of Maharaja Agrasen College, Delhi University, Tiwari emphasised that national development cannot be achieved without the active and constructive participation of young people. Principal professor Sanjeev Kumar Tiwari encouraged young people to pursue entrepreneurship rather than merely seek jobs. The programme was attended by Amit Pundir, Mukesh Agrawal, Gitika Saxena and Gitanjali Chawla. Ritu Kohli, Convenor of the Students' Advisory Committee along with a large number of students. The programme was conducted by Dr Indrani Das Gupta.



Kindathon Spotlight 2026 concludes

PIONEER NEWS SERIVCE
New Delhi

Kindathon Spotlight 2026 concluded at the Indira Gandhi Kala Kendra, bringing together around 200 people. The event was supported by Avian WE, with Itsy Bitsy as craft partner and CureAble as sensory partner. Program coordinating team was led by Aarti (Trisha Vaish), Ashish



Mishra, Nitya Bansal and Yash Jain. The evening included keynote addresses on employability and inclusion. Preeti Siwach, Head of Work and Employment at Action for Autism, National Centre for Autism India, spoke on employability and skilling. Leenika Khattar, Director, Diversity, Equity, Inclusion and Belonging at NASSCOM, also addressed the audience, and Simmi Vasu, Director, Clinical Excellence, Assessment and Therapy Services, CureAble, spoke on inclusion and family advocacy.

PARADIP PORT AUTHORITY
e-TENDER CALL NOTICE
No.CE/R&B/ACCTS-15/26/285
Dtd.09.10.2026

Name of Work: Annual Repair & Maintenance of Residential Sr. Officers' qtrs. (MVI, MV, GC & GD) at Madhuban area for the year 2026-27. Estimated cost: Rs.1,21,27,888.08 (Excluding GST). Last Date & time of submission of bid : **29.10.2026 up to 17:30 Hrs.** Refer our website for details: https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app.

Sd/- Executive Engineer,
Roads & Building Division, PPA
PPA/PR/31/2026-2027 dtd. 13.10.2026

M.P. MADHYA KSHETRA VIDYUT VITARAN CO. LTD.
(Govt. of M.P. Undertaking)
OFFICE OF THE GENERAL MANAGER (O&M) CIRCLE, HARDA
E-mail-ID : mpczgmharda@gmail.com
No. GM/O&M/HRD/NIT/2989 Harda, Dated 13.10.2026

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDERS

E-Tenders are invited from the eligible bidders for carrying out the following works :-

Name of Works	App. Value of Tender (In Crore) including GST	EMD Fee (In Rs.)	Tender Fee (In Rs.)	Date of Sale of Tender Documents	Opening Date of Tender Documents
Empanelment of Agencies for Restoration of Distribution Infrastructure during Emergency in Harda Circle	8.00 Cr.	25000/-	11800 with 18% GST	14.10.2026, 21:00 Hrs. up to 05.11.2026 14.00 Hrs.	06.11.2026 at 15:30 Hrs.

Other details, terms and conditions are available on company website : **https://portal.mpcz.in & https://mptenders.gov.in** or the under signed office.
M.P. Madhyam/128594/2026 GM (O&M) CIRCLE HARDA

RITES LIMITED
(A Government of India Enterprise)
Shikhar, Plot No. 1, Sector-29, Gurgaon-122001

Requirement of professionals for the following posts

VC No(s).	Individual Consultant & Contractual Post(s)	No. of Posts	Mode & Venue of Selection process
YP/67/26	Dy. Chief Signalling System Engineer / Chief Resident Engineer – Signalling	1	(Document Scrutiny & Interview) RITES Corporate Office Gurgaon /RITES Regional Office Kolkata/ Video conferencing
YP/68/26	Dy. Chief System Integration, Testing & Commissioning Expert	1	
YP/69/26	Dy. Chief Quality Assurance & Quality Control Expert for Works (Electrical)	1	
YP/70/26	Interface Manager / Coordinator – Electrical	1	
YP/71/26	Construction Planning, Programme cum Progress/ Monitoring Engineer	1	
YP/72/26	Track Expert	1	
YP/73/26	Environmental Expert	1	
YP/74/26	Section Engineer – SCADA	1	
YP/75/26	Resident Engineer – Signaling	1	
YP/76/26	Resident Engineer – Rolling Stock (Electrical)	1	
YP/77/26	BIM Manager	1	
YP/78/26	Resident Engineer – Civil	2	
YP/79/26	Resident Engineer – Track	1	
YP/80/26	Section Engineer – E&M	1	
YP/81/26	Section Engineer - Lift & Escalator	1	
YP/82/26	BIM Engineer	1	
YP/83/26	Section Engineer – Civil	1	
YP/84/26	Section Engineer – QA/QC	1	
YP/85/26	Site Engineer – Tunnel Ventilation, ECCS & Station Air conditioning	1	
YP/86/26	Site Engineer – AFC	1	
YP/87/26	Site Engineer – Rolling Stock	1	
YP/88/26	Site Engineer – Civil	1	
YP/89/26	Site Engineer – Track	1	
YP/90/26	Site Engineer – Environment	1	
YP/91/26	Site Engineer – QA & QC	1	
YP/92/26	Team Secretary	1	
CP/07-R2/26	Senior Manager (Mech.)- Bulk Material Handling Expert	1	Written Test / Interview
CL/08-R1/26	Engineer-UT Testing	2	Interview

For details regarding application, T&Cs, etc., candidates may see the detailed advertisement posted on RITES website **www.rites.com** under Career Section.

M.P. MADHYA KSHETRA VIDYUT VITARAN CO. LTD.
Office Of General Manager (City) Circle, Old Kisan Bank Building Sultaniya Road Bhopal-462001, Ph. : 0755-2678226, E-mail-secitybhopal@gmail.com., secitypur@gmail.com
Ref. No. GM/CC/Pur./2026-27/6327 Bhopal Dated :13.10.2026

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER (OPEN TENDER)

E-tenders are invited from the eligible bidders for carrying out the following works :-

Name of Works	App. Value of Tender including GST	EMD (In. Rs.)	Tender fee (Inclusive of GST @18%) (In Rs.)	Tender Submission Last Date & Time	Opening date of Tender Documents
Empanelment of Agencies for New 33/11KV Substation, additional /Augmentation of PTR at existing 33/11 KV S/s, HT Lines, LT Lines, DTR, Service Line and meter related works and any other associated works as per SOR schedules in GM City Circle of MPMKVVCL	1000.00 Lakh	25000/-	11,800 /-	12.11.2026 Up to 3.00 PM	13.11.2026 at 3.30 PM

Other details, terms and conditions are available on company website : **https://portal.mpcz.in & https://mptenders.gov.in** or the under signed office.
M.P. Madhyam/128596/2026 GENERAL MANAGER CITY CIRCLE BHOPAL

OFFICE OF UJJAIN DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
Pradhikaran Bhawan, Bharatpuri Administrative Zone, Dewas Road, Ujjain - 456010
email-udaujjain@gmail.com, website-www.udaujjain.org

Tender Notice

Online tenders are invited from eligible firms for the following work. Detailed tender details can be found on the website https://mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app

No.	Tender number & date of issue	Name of work	Work duration & PAC	Cost of Tender Form and EMD (INR)	Last date of tender
1.	UDA/ET/162/26 DATE 6-10-2026 2026_DTCP_541417_1	Integrated Development and Conservation of Maharishi Sandipani Ashram, Ujjain	365 days 1,30,75,63,000/-	59000/- 5000000/-	28/10/2026 17:30

Note: Any amendments to the tender will be published online only on the website and will not be published separately in newspapers

Executive Engineer, UDA, Ujjain

iexceed
Appzillon™
AI Powered Digital Banking Solutions
WWW.i-exceed.com

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | THURSDAY | OCTOBER 15, 2026

IIFL Capital's maiden pre-IPO fund raises ₹500 cr in first close



IIFL Capital Asset Management Ltd on Wednesday said it has raised around ₹500 crore in capital commitments at the first close of its maiden late-stage private equity fund. The fund targets a corpus of ₹1,000 crore, with a greenshoe option of an additional ₹1,000 crore, IIFL Capital said in a statement.

The IIFL Late-Stage Private Equity Fund achieved its first close on September 15, 2026, and will remain open for subscriptions, with the final close targeted within the next nine months, it said. (*PTI*)

Procedure for silver bullion import licences simplified



The Commerce Ministry has introduced a simplified, self-declaration-based procedure to speed up the issuance of import authorisations for certain silver items, aiming to reduce processing time for genuine applicants.

Imports of silver items are in a restricted category, under which a licence, authorisation, or permission is required from the Government.

"To facilitate trade and improve ease of doing business, a simplified procedure is being introduced for expedited issuance of import authorisations, based on self-declaration and trust, for import of silver items...excluding silver dore, with a view to reducing processing time for genuine applicants," the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) said in a trade notice. (*PTI*)

Fertiliser security is food security, and BRICS offers India a way to strengthen both



SS YADAV

From the Red Fort on 15 August, the Prime Minister drew attention to the strategic importance of ensuring affordable access to fertilisers amid rising global costs and growing geopolitical uncertainties-a reality well understood by those working across the fertiliser industry. He noted that the Government has absorbed massive costs to provide internationally priced urea costing around ₹3,000 for less than ₹300, and DAP costing over ₹5,000 for just ₹1,350. He further added that essential resources are increasingly being weaponised in the world today.

That difference of nearly ₹2,700 on a single bag of urea is, in the first instance, a measure of protection. It is the reason a farmer in Bundelkhand or Bolangir can plan a sowing season without tracking international commodity prices, and in a country of small and marginal landholdings, the Government's decision to carry that weight has kept millions of cropping decisions viable. The size of the gap is also a reminder of where our vulnerabilities lie, because it reflects how much of the fertiliser supply chain sits beyond our borders. The more useful question, therefore, is not whether the protection is justified, but how well we use the stability it creates.

Against this background, the agriculture provisions of the New Delhi Declaration, adopted at the 18th BRICS Summit in the capital last month, deserve closer attention than they have received. The Declaration does not treat fertiliser as one more line in a trade schedule, but places fertiliser shortages within the larger framework of food security, agricultural productivity and resilient supply chains. BRICS leaders emphasised the need to mitigate acute price volatility and abrupt supply disruptions, including fertiliser shortages, and called for international coordination to strengthen the availability, accessibility, stability and affordability of agricultural and food production inputs.

For those of us in the fertiliser industry, this language reflects a shift we have already witnessed. The long-standing assumption in global fertiliser trade was that a buyer with the means to pay could always find a seller. Export restrictions, energy price volatility and disruptions to shipping routes have made that far less certain, with availability increasingly becoming the constraint rather than price.

India has pursued two complementary objectives: strengthening domestic capability while building dependable international partnerships. Government data shows domestic urea production rising to 306.67 lakh metric tonnes in 2024-25, about 35 per cent above the level a decade earlier, while production of phosphatic and potassic fertilisers has also increased significantly over the same period. At the same time, Indian companies have moved beyond reliance on spot purchases, building long-term supply arrangements with major fertiliser-producing countries, including Saudi Arabia, Russia, Morocco and Jordan. These



partnerships have helped create more predictable and diversified supply channels, strengthening India's resilience against disruptions in global fertiliser markets.

This is where BRICS becomes relevant to our sector, because the grouping brings together in a single forum both some of the world's largest agricultural economies and several of its most significant fertiliser producers.

India's growing fertiliser relationship with Russia shows what such cooperation can achieve when pursued patiently. The larger opportunity, however, lies in moving beyond a collection of bilateral arrangements towards a predictable shared framework, in which rules are clear and responses to disruption are better coordinated across the wider BRICS agricultural ecosystem.

The Declaration points in that direction. It calls for facilitating intra-BRICS trade in agricultural products and production inputs through resilient and non-discriminatory supply chains, and supports further work on the proposed BRICS Grain Exchange, with a launch target of 2027 and scope for extension to other commodities. Of particular significance for our sector is the establishment of BRICS AGRIN, the Agro-Inputs, Genetic Resources and Information Network, conceived as a collaborative, voluntary and farmer centric platform, complemented by closer cooperation on agroecology, regenerative agriculture and digital agriculture.

Frameworks of this kind are, it must be said, easier to draft than to operationalise, and their value will be judged by how quickly their provisions become working institutions with defined timelines. That is why India's position matters at this juncture. As host of the Summit and one of the largest fertiliser consumers within the grouping, it is well placed to help ensure these commitments are carried forward with seriousness and pace.

This complements the vision of Aatmanirbhar Bharat. Self-reliance in fertilisers is sometimes misunderstood as a withdrawal from global markets, which it cannot be, since geology rather than policy determines where the world's potash and rock phosphate reserves lie. It means building enough capacity, storage and sourcing flexibility to engage with world markets from a position of confidence rather than compulsion.

It is here that the cooperative sector has a particular responsibility: farmers should not have to bear the volatility they had no part in creating. At KRIBHCO, we work at the point where national policy either reaches a farmer or fails to, and our task is not simply to place fertiliser in a village at the right time, important as that is. It is also to ensure that every kilogram of nutrient entering a field does the work it is meant to do, through balanced nutrient management, soil test based application, more efficient products, and the patient work of changing practices followed for generations. A country that imports less and wastes less is doubly secure, and efficiency, in that sense, is domestic capacity by another name.

The question before us is therefore changing in character, from how we secure the next consignment to how we build a fertiliser system that holds when the external environment turns uncertain. The Prime Minister's message from the Red Fort was, in the end, about preparedness, and about national capability being the most dependable form of insurance.

India should continue to build at home, deepen its partnerships abroad and work collectively through platforms such as BRICS. When the security of fertiliser supply is strengthened, so is the security of the Indian farmer, and with it the food security of the nation.

The writer is Managing Director, KRIBHCO


नरेन्द्र मोदी
प्रधानमंत्री

सत्यमेव जयते
दिल्ली सरकार

दिल्ली पीएम सूर्य घर
मुफ्त बिजली योजना


रेखा गुप्ता
मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

3 kW तक का सोलर पैनल ₹0

मुफ्त सोलर पैनल लगवाएं,
मुफ्त बिजली पाएं और हर महीने ₹300 से ₹2,400 तक की कमाई भी करें

पहले आओ पहले पाओ



योजना के तहत मिलने वाले लाभ अपनी मासिक बिजली खपत के अनुसार देखें

मासिक बिजली खपत	लाभ
0-200 यूनिट	▸ 3 kW तक मुफ्त सोलर पैनल ▸ बिजली बिल जीरो ▸ बिजली बचत में 50% तक अतिरिक्त प्रोत्साहन ▸ ग्रिड को दी गई अतिरिक्त बिजली से अतिरिक्त कमाई
201-400 यूनिट	▸ 3 kW तक मुफ्त सोलर पैनल ▸ बिजली बिल में बचत ▸ ₹800 तक बिजली सब्सिडी (योग्य बिल पर) ▸ ग्रिड को दी गई अतिरिक्त बिजली से अतिरिक्त कमाई
>400 यूनिट	▸ ₹1.56 लाख तक सब्सिडी ▸ 3-10 kW सोलर प्लांट पर ▸ ग्रिड को दी गई अतिरिक्त बिजली से अतिरिक्त कमाई

21 सितंबर, 2026 से
पंजीकरण शुरू हो चुका है
solar.delhi.gov.in

पंजीकरण के लिए
QR कोड स्कैन करें

DIP/Shabdarth/Display/111/26-27

TRANSGLOBE ADVISORS

Your Trusted Management Advisory

www.transglobeadvisors.in

SC asks MEA to notify kin of Russia war victims

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Observing that the right to seek compensation has to be enforced, the Supreme Court on Wednesday asked the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) to consider issuing a public notice inviting families of Indians who have died while fighting in the Russia-Ukraine war to seek assistance and compensation.

The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA), in its latest status report, apprised a bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Joymalya Bagchi that 51 Indians who fought the war have died and 77 recruits remain untraced so far.

The top court asked the MEA to file a fresh status report giving details of exact compensation given by the Russian Government to six families whose members died in the war zone there.

The direction to this effect was passed after Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati, appearing for the Centre, said that so far six compensation claims have been processed by the Russian Government. She added that five compensation claims have been satisfied fully and one partially.

The Bench said that the right to seek compensation accrues to the families of all 51 persons who unfortunately lost their lives there.

It also asked the District Legal Services Authorities of Rajasthan, Punjab, Haryana and Himachal Pradesh to comply with its earlier direction to provide free legal aid to the aggrieved families for"submission of claims and/or conducting of DNA test, apart from other necessary legal/ administrative formalities which are required to be completed by them".

ASG Bhati informed the bench that approximately 267 Indians had joined the Russian armed forces, of whom 51 had died and 139 had been discharged from military service.

The Indian embassy in Russia is pursuing the whereabouts of 77 recruits, including seven whom Russian authorities have confirmed as missing. The Bench took note of the MEA's submission that officials were contacting the affected families individually and expected the authorities to facilitate their compensation claims.

It also considered the difficulties in securing compensation from Russia, delays in DNA-based identification and the repatriation of mortal remains. The additional solicitor general told the bench that all possible efforts were being made to assist the families."Ultimately, our diplomatic and consular efforts will help," Bhati submitted, adding that Russian authorities had been cooperating and the government would continue to pursue requests to simplify the process.

The bench also examined the case of one Sikandar Singh who was sentenced to eight years' imprisonment in Russia in a molestation case. The bench was urged to ask the MEA to explore the possibility so that he can be shifted to an Indian jail to serve the remainder of the sentence. The law officer said that for this, Singh will have to withdraw his appeal against conviction from an appellate court there.

The petitioners also sought action against agents allegedly involved in recruiting Indians for the Russian armed forces through false promises of employment.

At the outset, the law officer said that a nodal officer has been appointed in pursuance of an earlier order.

On July 31, the top court had directed the Centre to appoint a nodal officer in the MEA to coordinate with the families of those who have died, gone missing or suffered injuries while fighting in the Russia-Ukraine war.

It had also directed the MEA to facilitate DNA matching of family members with the mortal remains.

The bench was hearing a plea pertaining to Indian nationals recruited into the Russian military after being allegedly duped by travel agents.

Order Order

Allahabad HC asks State poll panel to hold panchayat elections



The Allahabad High Court on Wednesday directed the State Election Commission to hold polls to Panchayati Raj institutions in Uttar Pradesh within three months.

The order was passed by a bench comprising Justices Ajit Kumar and Garima Prashad.

The petitioner had moved court seeking direction to the State Election Commission to place on record a detailed time bound schedule for completion of the entire panchayat election process well before the expiry of district panchayat tenure."It is expected from respondent No.2 (State Election Commission) that the entire schedule of holding the election should be finalised and brought on record before the next date of listing," the court observed, while allowing the plea by Dashrath Yadav. (*PTI*)

Asaduddin Owaisi moves SC challenging SIR, alleges lapses



AIMIM chief Asaduddin Owaisi on Wednesday moved the Supreme Court challenging the manner in which the Election Commission is conducting the SIR, claiming that the constitutional and statutory safeguards have been overlooked and the voting rights of eligible citizens have been jeopardised.

A bench comprising Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi took note of the submission of advocate Nizam Pasha, appearing for Owaisi, that the plea be listed on Thursday along with other pending ones on the issue. Assuring consideration, the CJI-led bench indicated that it would examine the matter and the reference to similar petitions. Pasha submitted that the relevant cases had been identified in the memo accompanying his request for listing.

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi and 10 prominent opposition leaders and others have also moved the top court against the alleged malpractices in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and other related processes.

Owaisi, in his plea filed through lawyer Lzafeer Ahmad, has sought judicial intervention to ensure that the revision process complies with the Representation of the People Act and the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960.

"Declare that the decisions affecting the SIR not duly authorised in accordance with the law, including Section 18 of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023, are liable to be set aside," the plea said.

The plea said it does not challenge the Election Commission's (EC) authority to conduct an intensive revision of electoral rolls. Instead, it questions whether the EC has exercised that authority lawfully, transparently and through procedures prescribed by law.

"Declare that the forms prescribed under the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960, cannot be superseded or supplemented by alternative forms or substantive conditions introduced through portal modifications or executive instructions unsupported by law," it said. (*PTI*)

Kerala HC declines to stay toll collection on NH 66 at Nattika plaza



The Kerala High Court on Wednesday declined to stay toll collection at the Nattika plaza on National Highway 66 after the NHAI and the Centre submitted that the fee was being collected only for the completed portion of the road.

Counsel for the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) and the Union Ministry of Road Transport and Highways told a bench comprising Chief Justice Soumen Sen and Justice Syam Kumar V M that 51 km of the 60-km Kappirikkad-Kodungallur stretch in Thrissur district had been completed."Only one flyover and two viaducts remain to be completed. The toll is being collected only for the completed portion," the counsel said.

He submitted that toll collection should begin within 45 days of the issuance of the completion certificate, as the project was funded by public money. In view of the submissions, the bench sought responses from the ministry, the NHAI and the Keralam Government on a public interest litigation challenging toll collection at the Nattika toll plaza. (*PTI*)

Protests: No curtailment or cancellation of services, DMRC tells Supreme Court

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) on Wednesday informed the Supreme Court that there was no curtailment or cancellation of metro train services in view of October 10 protests in the national capital and the entry and exit were restricted at just 45 out of the 303 stations.

In an affidavit filed in the apex court, the DMRC also said the number of commuters on October 10 was slightly lower than the ridership on a normal second Saturday which shows the"adverse impact" of protest on the lives of ordinary citizens.

The top court was dealing with several petitions before the Supreme Court in connection with the October 10 protests and detention of those who were out on streets demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar over his handling of special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and the functioning of Election Commission of India (ECI). As many as 15 petitions have been filed so far.

The protests called by various youth bodies and political parties in Delhi had led to large scale detentions and assault of protestors as well as journalists and lawyers on October 10 and October 11.

The petitions before the Supreme Court include writ petitions, contempt proceedings, habeas corpus pleas and intervention applications challenging restrictions on public transport, alleged unlawful detentions and police action against lawyers, journalists and protesters.

According to DMRC affidavit, over 85 per cent of metro network (258 stations) remained fully operational, accessible and functional for commuters. The DMRC said the entry and exit were restricted at only 45 out of 303 stations, accounting for 15 per cent of the entire network, from 9 pm of October 9 till October 10.

IYC moves Delhi High court over Jantar Mantar de-notification

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Indian Youth Congress (IYC) on Wednesday approached the Delhi High Court challenging the de-notification of Jantar Mantar as a designated protest and demonstration site.

The Indian Youth Congress filed the application through its president, Uday Bhanu Chib, in a pending petition seeking permission to hold protests at the Jantar Mantar in central Delhi against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar for alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise.

In the application, the petitioner challenged Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar's standing order dated October 11, which de-notified Jantar Mantar . In its order, the Delhi Police said a detailed and revised standard operating procedure (SOP) for protests at the three venues will be issued separately.

Advocate Roopesh Singh Bhadauria filed the latest application after amending the existing petition. When the pending petition came up for hearing on October 12, the Delhi Police told the high court that the decision to denotify Jantar Mantar as the designated protest site was taken pursuant to the directions of the Supreme Court.

PUBLIC NOTICE

My clients Lokesh Kumar S/o Ram Ji Lal R/o 337A, Village Barwala, North West Delhi, Delhi-110039, has severed his all relations from his son Chirag Kadam and disowned him from his all moveable and immoveable properties due to his disobedience. If anybody deals with him will do so at his/her own risk cost and consequences. My client shall not be responsible for his any acts.

L. BIRAM SINGH (Advocate)
Ch. No.1022 Rohini Court Delhi-85

PUBLIC NOTICE

To be known to all that my client Mrs. Neelam Kamal Parwani W/o Shri Kamal Parwani, R/o 24, Parth Bhoomi Bunglows, Near Asim Bunglows, Govt. Tubewell, PO: Bopal, DIST: Ahmedabad, Gujarat – 380058, mutatee/lessee/ allottee of DDA BUILT UP JANTA FLAT NO.387, ON GROUND FLOOR, SITUATED AT SITE-1, VIKAS PURI, NEW DELHI-110018, has applied for conversion of the aforesaid flat from lease hold to free hold in DDA. Original Demand Letter, Possession Letter, NOC for Water Electricity Connection, and Site Possession Slip, of the above flat have been lost. An F.I.R. to this effect has been lodged in the concerned Police Station. Any person(s) claiming any right, interest, having any objection or found in possession of original documents, may write/contract with above named person at above Address/ Mob No.9327668397, within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice. The person claiming any right, interest, objection with respect to this property, can personally inform or write to Deputy Director (LAB) Housing or Director(H)I, D Block, 3rd Floor, Vikas Sadan, INA, New Delhi.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM

Ref: - i) Tender notice No. 45/2026-2027 dated 23.09.2026
ii) Tender No. 03263126 due on 14.10.2026.

With reference to the above-mentioned tender, the following corrigendum has been issued:

Sl. No.	From	To
01	Drawing No. MI006232, Alt.-c	Drawing No. MI006232, Alt.-e
02	Due Date: 14.10.2026	Due Date: 23.10.2026

All other terms and conditions of the tender shall remain unchanged.
The corrigendum has been published on the IREPS website: **www.ireps.gov.in**.

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE
3588/2026

GOVERNMENT OF ASSAM |অসম চৰকাৰ
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER | মুখ্য অভিযন্তাৰ কার্যালয়::
PWD BUILDING | লোক নির্মাণ (গৃহ) বিভাগ::
ASSAM:: GUWAHATI| অসম :: গুৱাহাটী-৩

No. CEB/CS/TB-IV(B)/01/2026/18

PRESS NOTICE
নিবিদা আহ্বান কৰা জাননী

The Chief Engineer, PWD (Building), Assam, Chandmari, Guwahati-03 on behalf of the Governor of Assam, invites fresh bid for the work detailed in the table below, from eligible Firm/Contractor of repute having experience in similar nature of work. Details of bid may be seen at e -procurement portal i.e.www.assamtenders.gov.in

The bidders must be enrolled with e-tendering web portal www.assamtenders.gov.in

মুখ্য অভিযন্তা, লোক নির্মাণ (গৃহ) বিভাগ, অসম, চান্দমাৰি, গুৱাহাটী-০৩ এ অসমৰ ৰাজ্যপালৰ হৈ, তলত উল্লেখিত কামৰ বাবে একে ধৰণৰ কামৰ অভিজ্ঞতা থকা যোগ্য ফার্ম/ঠিকাদাৰৰ পৰা নিবিদা আহ্বান কৰিছে। নিবিদাৰ সবিশেষ ই-ক্রয় পৰ্টেল অর্থাৎ www.assamtenders.gov.in ত চাব পাৰিব।

নিবিদাকাৰীসকলে ই-টেণ্ডাৰ ৰেব পৰ্টেল www.assamtenders.gov.in ৰ জৰিয়তে নামভর্তি কৰিব লাগিব।

Sl. No. ক্রমিক নম্বৰ	Name of work কামৰ নাম	Approx. Value of work (in Rs) কামৰ আনুমানিক মূল্য (টকাত)	Bid Security নিবিদা 1সুৰক্ষা জমা	Bid Processing Fee (in Rs) নিবিদা প্রক্রিয়াকৰণ মাচুল (টকাত)	Completion period কার্য সমাপ্তিৰ সময়সীমা
1.	Construction of Cultural Complex of Shankardev Shishu Niketan at Hajongbari, Kamrup (Metro), Assam: Phase II অসমৰ কামৰূপ (মেট্রো) জিলাৰ হাজংবাৰীত স্থিত শংকৰদেৱ শিশু নিকেতন সাংস্কৃতিক প্রকল্প নির্মাণ: দ্বিতীয় পর্যায়	4,80,42,950.00 ৪,৮০,৪২,৯৫০.০০	2 % for General category or 1 % for Reserved category on value of work সাধাৰণ শ্রেণীৰ বাবে কামৰ মূল্যৰ 2% বা সংৰক্ষিত শ্রেণীৰ বাবে কামৰ মূল্যৰ ১ %	9609.00 ৯৬০৯.০০	12 (Twelve) Months ১২ (বাৰ) মাহ

Note টোকা:
(i) The value of work may change during uploading of DNIT for which no claim will be entertained. ডিএনআইটি আপলোড কৰাৰ সময়ত কামৰ মূল্য সলনি হ'ব পাৰে যাৰ বাবে কোনো দাবী গ্রহণ কৰা নহ'ব।
(ii) The Press Notice will be a part of the Bidding Documents. নিবিদা আহ্বান কৰা জাননী নিবিদা নথিপত্রৰ অংশ হ'ব।
(iii) The earlier Press Notice published vide No. **CEB/CS/TB-IV(B)/01/2026/14 Date: 04.07.2026** may be treated as cancelled. পূর্বৰ প্রকাশিত প্রেছ নোটিচ নং **CEB/CS/TB-IV(B)/01/2026/14 তাৰিখ: 04.07.2026** বাতিল হোৱা বুলি গণ্য কৰা হ'ব।

Chief Engineer, PWD (Building),
Assam, Chandmari, Guwahati-03
মুখ্য অভিযন্তা, লোক নির্মাণ (গৃহ) বিভাগ,
অসম, চান্দমাৰি, গুৱাহাটী-০৩

DIPR/C/PIO/144/15-Oct-26

The Pioneer
Classified

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Ram Kumar, Father of JC-471546X Sub Maj Clk (SD) Shri Parkash, R/o- Vill & PO- Gubhana, Teh- Bahadurgarh, Dist- Jhajjar, Haryana - 124507, have changed my name from Ram Kumar to Ram Kuwar, vide affidavit dated 14/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, No.15418304A Hav Ransing Sampat Tatyasaheb, R/o- Vill & PO- Alsunde, Dist- Ahmadnagar, Maharashtra- 414402, have changed my Father's name in my service record from Ransing Tatya Saheb to Tatya Bhausaheb Ransing, vide affidavit dated 14/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, No.15418304A Hav Ransing Sampat Tatyasaheb, R/o- Vill & PO- Alsunde, Dist- Ahmadnagar, Maharashtra- 414402, have changed my Mother's name in my service record from Ransingh Vijaya Tatya Saheb to Vijaya Tatya Ransing, vide affidavit dated 14/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Uttamrao Harishakha Nalawade, Father of JC-282889K Sub Maj Nalawade Tatyaso Uttam, R/o- Vill- Mahadikwadi, PO- Shegaon, Teh- Jath, Dist- Sangli, Maharashtra- 416404, have changed my name from Uttamrao Harishakha Nalawade to Uttam Harisakha Nalwade, vide affidavit dated 14/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Byakk Uttam, Mother of JC-282889K Sub Maj Nalawade Tatyaso Uttam, R/o- Vill- Mahadikwadi, PO- Shegaon, Teh- Jath, Dist- Sangli, Maharashtra- 416404, have changed my name from Byakk Uttam to Bayakka Uttam Nalwade, vide affidavit dated 14/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Lanka, Mother of No. 6504792W SEP/ASH Bodke Sunil Dilip, R/o- At Post- Pimpalgaon Nipani, Teh- Niphad, Dist- Nashik, Maharashtra- 422102, have changed my name from Lanka to Bodke Lankabai Dilip, vide affidavit dated 14/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Gaztri, Mother of- JC-304949W Sub(OFC) Bawa Dass, R/o- Vill- Gurwal, PO- Vijaypur, Teh & Dist- Samba, J & K- 184120, have changed my name from Gaztri to Gyatri Devi, vide affidavit dated 14/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Shripal Chauhan, Father of- No.15689239Y Ex-Hav Ram Chauhan, R/o- Vill & PO- Barka, Teh- Baraut, Dist- Baghpat, U.P.- 250611, have changed my name from Shripal Chauhan to Sri Pal, vide affidavit dated 14/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Kamlesh Devi, Mother of- No.15689239Y Ex-Hav Ram Chauhan, R/o- Vill & PO- Barka, Teh- Baraut, Dist- Baghpat, U.P.- 250611, have changed my name from Kamlesh Devi to Kamlesh, vide affidavit dated 14/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, JC-706303X Sub/Lt Pramendra Kumar Singh, R/o- At/Po- Narangarh, Teh- Khurda, PS- Jankia, Dist- Khurda, Odisha- 752018, have changed my mother's name from Kesha Devi to Kesha Singh, vide affidavit dated 14/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Priya, W/o- No. 22052668A Sep Dipak Kumar, R/o- Vill- Chorbhatthi Kala, Post- Ganiyari, Dist- Bilaspur, State- Chhattisgarh, Pin- 495112, have changed my name from Priya to Priya Kaushik, vide affidavit dated 14/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Sima Devi, W/o- No.15422002L Hav Bhanwar Lal Vishnoi, R/o- Vill- Deepawat Nagar, Fateh Sagar, PO- Peelwa, Teh- Phalodi, Dist- Jodhpur, Rajasthan- 342309, have changed my name from Sima Devi to Seema Devi, vide affidavit dated 14/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Krishna Kumari, Mother of JC-472690Y Sub Dinesh Kumar Singh, R/o- Vill- Madhaopur, PO- Dharawara, Teh- Karchhana, Dist- Prayagraj, U.P - 212301, have changed my name from Krishna Kumari to Krishna Murari Devi, vide affidavit dated 14/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Meesala Venkata Rao, Father of No.2623490P Sep Meesala Hariprasad, R/o- C-27 Saliveedhi Vill- Gudivada, Teh- Bhogapuram, Dist- Vizianagaram, Andhra Pradesh- 531162, have changed my name from Meesala Venkata Rao to Meesala Venkatarao, vide affidavit dated 14/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Deergasi Balarama Swamy Father of- JC-283044X Sub Maj (OPRADIO) Deergasi Venkata Rao, R/o- Silagam (Vill), Calingapatnam (Post), Gara (Teh), Srikakulam (Dist), Andhra Pradesh- 532406, have changed my name from Deergasi Balarama Swamy to Deergasi Balaramaswamy, vide affidavit dated 14/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Deergasi Kantamma, Mother of- JC-283044X Sub Maj (OPRADIO) Deergasi Venkata Rao, R/o- Silagam (Vill), Calingapatnam (Post), Gara (Teh), Srikakulam (Dist), Andhra Pradesh- 532406, have changed my name from Deergasi Kantamma to Deergasi Kanthamma, vide affidavit dated 14/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Harpal Singh S/o Kulwant Singh R/o CL-3A L-Block, Anand Vihar Hari Nagar New Delhi-110064 have changed my name to Harpal Singh Suri.

I, Manoj Kumar (UID: 2653 9157 4610) S/o Sh. Ashok Kumar R/o B-76, B-Block, Ganga Vihar, Sabapur, Seelampur, North East Delhi-110094 declare that My Daughter Navya & Navya Aggarwal both are the names of one and same person.

I, Vimla W/o Sh. Manoj Kumar, R/o H.No. 29, Second Floor, T Huts, Safdarjung Flyover, Lodhi Road Central Delhi, Delhi-110003 declare that Bijma and Vimla are one and the same person. My correct name is Vimla as per Aadhar Card and all documents.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | THURSDAY | OCTOBER 15, 2026

West Indies secure 24-run win in fourth T20

HIMANK NEGI ■ Hyderabad

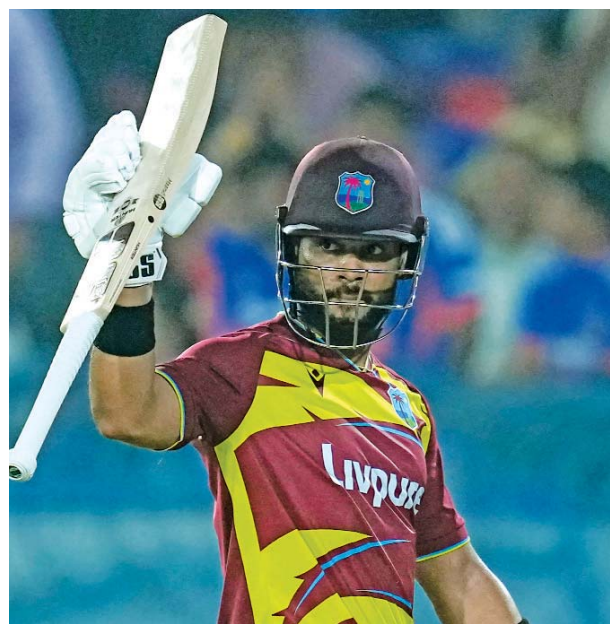
Keemo Paul produced a match-winning five-wicket haul to wreck India's chase after Shai Hope's stunning hundred, as the West Indies secured a 24-run victory in the fourth T20 International here on Wednesday to force a series decider in Bengaluru. Paul returned figures of 4-0-41-5, claiming his second five-wicket haul in T20 internationals, after his 5/15 against Bangladesh in Dhaka in 2018. His decisive spell helped visitors defend a total of 247/3, built around Hope's century, and level five-match series at 2-2. India ended at 223 all out in 19.3 overs. India made an explosive start to the chase, with Sanju Samson taking the attack to the West Indies bowlers. The opener smashed 56 off just 23 balls, striking six fours and four sixes as the hosts raced to 60 without loss in four overs.

Samson reached his half-century in just 20 deliveries, but Paul turned the contest in the fifth over by removing the opener and Ishan Kishan in quick succession. Samson was caught by Shimron Hetmyer, while Kishan departed for six off three balls, leaving India at 69/2.

Shreyas Iyer attempted to steady the innings but fell for 16 off 11 balls to Shamar Springer. Abhishek Sharma, who struck three fours and a six in his 29 off 24 deliveries, also failed to convert his start into a substantial contribution. Gudakesh Motie then delivered a crucial double strike in the 12th over, dismissing Abhishek and Naman Dhir, who was stumped for a golden duck. Motie finished with figures of 2-0-13-2, leaving India struggling at 132/5 and firmly shifting the pressure on the home side.

Tilak Varma and Nitish Kumar Reddy mounted a spirited counterattack to revive India's hopes. The pair added 59 runs off just 26 balls, with Tilak striking 43 off 25 deliveries and Reddy smashing 41 off 20 balls.

Reddy took on Shamar Joseph in the 16th over, collecting a four and two sixes in a 21-run over that brought India to 189/5. With the required rate still within reach, the partnership briefly threatened to turn the game around.



Romario Shepherd broke the stand in the 17th over, dismissing Tilak with Rovman Powell taking the catch. Paul then returned to dismantle the lower order, removing Reddy and Prince Yadav in successive deliveries before Axar Patel fell for three, completing his five-wicket haul and leaving India's chase in disarray. India's resistance ended in 19.4 overs. Arshdeep Singh, who made five off four balls, was struck on the left bicep by a sharp short delivery from Joseph in the final over. After receiving attention, he left the field, with the scorecard recording him as retired out. Earlier, Hope produced a breathtaking unbeaten 102 off 50 balls to power the West Indies to 247/3 after India elected to bowl. He completed his century with a six off the final delivery of the innings, recording his third T20 International hundred and second century of the series.

Hope was particularly severe during the powerplay, as the West Indies raced to 79/1 in the first six overs, their joint-highest powerplay total against India in T20Is. The visitors brought up 100 in 7.4 overs, matching the fastest team century against India in the format.

Sherfane Rutherford provided the finishing flourish with an unbeaten 49 off 26 balls, adding 91 runs with Hope in just 43 deliveries. Shimron Hetmyer contributed 33 off 12 balls, while Rovman Powell made 24 off 17. India struggled to contain the onslaught, with Mayank Yadav and Arshdeep Singh conceding 52 runs apiece. The West Indies struck 17 sixes and benefited from 17 extras to post a commanding total, setting up a winner-takes-all contest in Bengaluru on Saturday. (*PTI*)

ACA opens new cricket ground and pavilion at Naharkatia

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Guwahati



Assam Cricket Association (ACA) on Tuesday inaugurated a state-of-the-art cricket ground and pavilion at Naharkatia, marking a significant step towards expanding cricket infrastructure beyond the traditional centres of the state.

Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma inaugurated the facility in the presence of BCCI Honorary Secretary Devajit Saikia, ACA President and MLA Taranga Gogoi and other dignitaries. The new complex has five centre pitches, a fully furnished pavilion including match officials' room and dressing rooms, practice facilities, and infrastructure suitable for hosting domestic matches.

CM Sarma said the inauguration marked a new beginning for Naharkatia. "This is a proud day for Naharkatia. This initiative will help young cricketers move ahead and fulfil their dreams," he said.

The Chief Minister also praised the Assam Cricket Association for its efforts to develop cricket infrastructure and promote the sport across the State. BCCI Secretary Devajit Saikia highlighted the importance of developing cricket facilities outside Guwahati and other established centres, with the new Naharkatia facility expected to strengthen the grassroots cricket pathway in Upper Assam.

"The facility at Naharkatia will also serve as the ACA Cricket Academy's satellite academy for the Upper Assam Zone in the coming days. This will provide young cricketers in the region with access to structured training and development programmes," said Saikia.

ACA President Taranga Gogoi said they are proud to play a role in building cricket infrastructure in the state. He also highlighted the ACA's vision of taking cricket to every corner of Assam, ensuring that talent from smaller towns and rural areas receives the right platform to grow

The inauguration was attended by ACA Vice President Romen Dutta, Joint Secretary Rajendra Singh, Treasurer Anupam Deka, Apex Council member Mukutananda Bhattacharjya and former Apex Council members, besides officials of the Cricket Association of Naharkatia and other guests.

ITBP honours Mt Abi Gamin team and Asiad medal winners

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi



The Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP) organised a flag-in ceremony at its Force Headquarters on Wednesday to mark the successful completion of the Mount Abi Gamin Expedition-2026, alongside a felicitation ceremony honoring force sportspersons who excelled in national and international competitions.

ITBP Director General Shatrujeet Kapur graced the occasion as the chief guest, in the presence of Additional Director General (HQ) Sanjay Gunjyal, senior officers, mountaineers, sportspersons, and support staff. The event commenced with a welcome address by Deputy Inspector General (Sports) Pawan Malik.

The expedition team successfully summited the 7,355-metre high Mount Abi Gamin peak on September 16, adding another landmark achievement to the ITBP's distinguished mountaineering legacy.

During the event, personnel who delivered stellar performances between January and October 2026 were honoured with the DG's Insignia and Commendation Roll. Among the key awardees were Assistant Sub-Inspector Parveen, who won a Gold Medal in Boxing at the 20th Asian Games in Japan, and Constable Neeraj Chauhan, who secured a Silver and a Bronze Medal in Archery.

Addressing the gathering, Kapur congratulated the mountaineers and medal winners, stating that high-altitude mountaineering is integral to the ITBP's operational ethos, forging mental resilience and physical endurance required for adverse border terrains. He reaffirmed the force's commitment to providing modern training infrastructure and sustained support to its sportspersons.

Ishani wins two golds, bronze at IUKL World Kettlebell title

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi



Indian kettlebell athlete Ishani Sirohi secured two gold medals and a bronze at the recently concluded 2026 International Union of Kettlebell Lifting (IUKL) World Championship, held at Talkatora Indoor Stadium in New Delhi from October 5 to 9.

The championship brought together over 300 athletes from 12 countries, including Russia, Australia, the United States, Uzbekistan and Poland. The event was held in association with the Kettlebell Sport India Association (KSIA), the Indian federation affiliated with IUKL.

Sirohi clinched her first gold medal in the women's Military Snatch event, completing 206 repetitions with a 16 kg kettlebell. She added a second gold in the women's team relay, where the Indian squad defeated Australia with a collective tally of 154 repetitions using double 16 kg kettlebells.

Sirohi also secured bronze in the women's two arm jerk event, completing 54 repetitions with two 16 kg kettlebells. She finished behind competitors from Russia and Australia.

The three-medal performance marked another successful international outing for Sirohi, who had earlier won silver in the 30-minute Half Snatch Marathon and bronze in Military Snatch at the 2026 IKMF World Championships in Syracuse, New York. Apart from competing, Sirohi also served as a judge at the championship, contributing to the technical officiating of the international event.

The championship saw participation across multiple age groups and competitive categories, highlighting the growing international reach of kettlebell sport, a discipline that combines strength, endurance and technical precision.

Member of Parliament Bansuri Swaraj attended as chief guest on the opening day, while Paralympic medallist Deepa Malik was present on the second day. Sirohi's performance adds to India's achievements in international kettlebell competition, particularly in women's strength sports, as Indian athletes continue to make their presence felt in disciplines beyond mainstream sporting events.

